

PAPER 2: CONFLICT IN THE MIDDLE EAST, 1945-1995



Name: _____

Class: _____

Progress & Assessment Tracker

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Do Now	Level	Teacher Comment
KT1: Geography of the Middle East	N/A		
KT1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949	Do Now: / 3		
KT1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War	Do Now: / 10		
KT1.3: Increased Tension, 1955–1963	Do Now: / 10		
KT2.1: The Six Day War, 1967	Do Now: / 5		
KT2.2: The Aftermath of the 1967 War	Do Now: / 10		
KT2.3: Israel and Egypt, 1967–1973	Do Now: / 10		
KT3.1: Diplomatic negotiations, 1974–1979	Do Now: / 10		
KT3.2: The Palestinian Issue, 1974–1993	Do Now: / 10		
KT3.3: Attempts at a solution, 1988–1995	Do Now: / 10		
Final Unit Grade:			

KT1: Geography of the Middle East

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Identify the key countries and capital cities involved in the Arab-Israeli conflict.
- ☐ Locate strategic chokepoints and contested regions.
- ☐ Locate and label the Occupied Territories (West Bank, Gaza Strip, Golan Heights, Sinai Peninsula).

Map Task: The Geopolitical Landscape

Understanding the geography of the Middle East is the essential first step to understanding its history. The borders of the modern Middle East were largely drawn by Britain and France following the collapse of the Ottoman Empire at the end of the First World War. These artificially imposed borders laid the groundwork for decades of instability.

At the heart of the conflict are several highly contested regions: the Gaza Strip, the West Bank, the Golan Heights, and the Sinai Peninsula. Additionally, control over strategic waterways—like the Suez Canal, the Straits of Tiran, and the River Jordan—has repeatedly triggered military escalation.

Source A

Reference Map



Q1. Using the blank map provided in your workbook (or the interactive map here), label the following: - Countries: Israel, Egypt, Syria, Jordan, Lebanon, Iraq, Iran - Capitals: Jerusalem, Tel Aviv, Cairo, Damascus, Amman, Beirut - Waterways: Suez Canal, Straits of Tiran, Gulf of Aqaba, Red Sea, River Jordan, Mediterranean Sea - Contested Zones (shade these): Sinai Peninsula, Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank

Documentary / General Notes

Title / Topic: _____



KT1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.
- ☐ Analyze the key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181.
- ☐ Describe the key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

In 1945, the world was reeling from the horrors of the Holocaust, creating immense international pressure for a Jewish homeland. Yet, for the Arab population of Palestine, this meant the terrifying prospect of losing their ancestral land. The British, exhausted and bankrupt from World War Two, were caught in the middle of an impossible situation.

Did you know?

- 1917: The Balfour Declaration originally promised British support for a national home for the Jewish people.
- 100,000: The number of Jewish Holocaust survivors US President Truman demanded Britain immediately allow into Palestine.
- 1947: The year Britain gave up and handed the Palestine problem to the newly created United Nations.

Q1. What impact did the King David Hotel bombing have on the British Mandate?

Source A: The Ruins of the King David Hotel, 1946



The southern wing of the King David Hotel in Jerusalem following the Irgun bomb attack on 22 July 1946.

Q1. What impact did the King David Hotel bombing have on the British Mandate?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 3

1.



Who is this historical figure, and what did he controversially promise in 1917?

2. How many Jewish people were systematically murdered during the Holocaust (1939-1945)?

3. At the end of WWII in 1945, what happened to hundreds of thousands of Jewish survivors?

Vocabulary Check

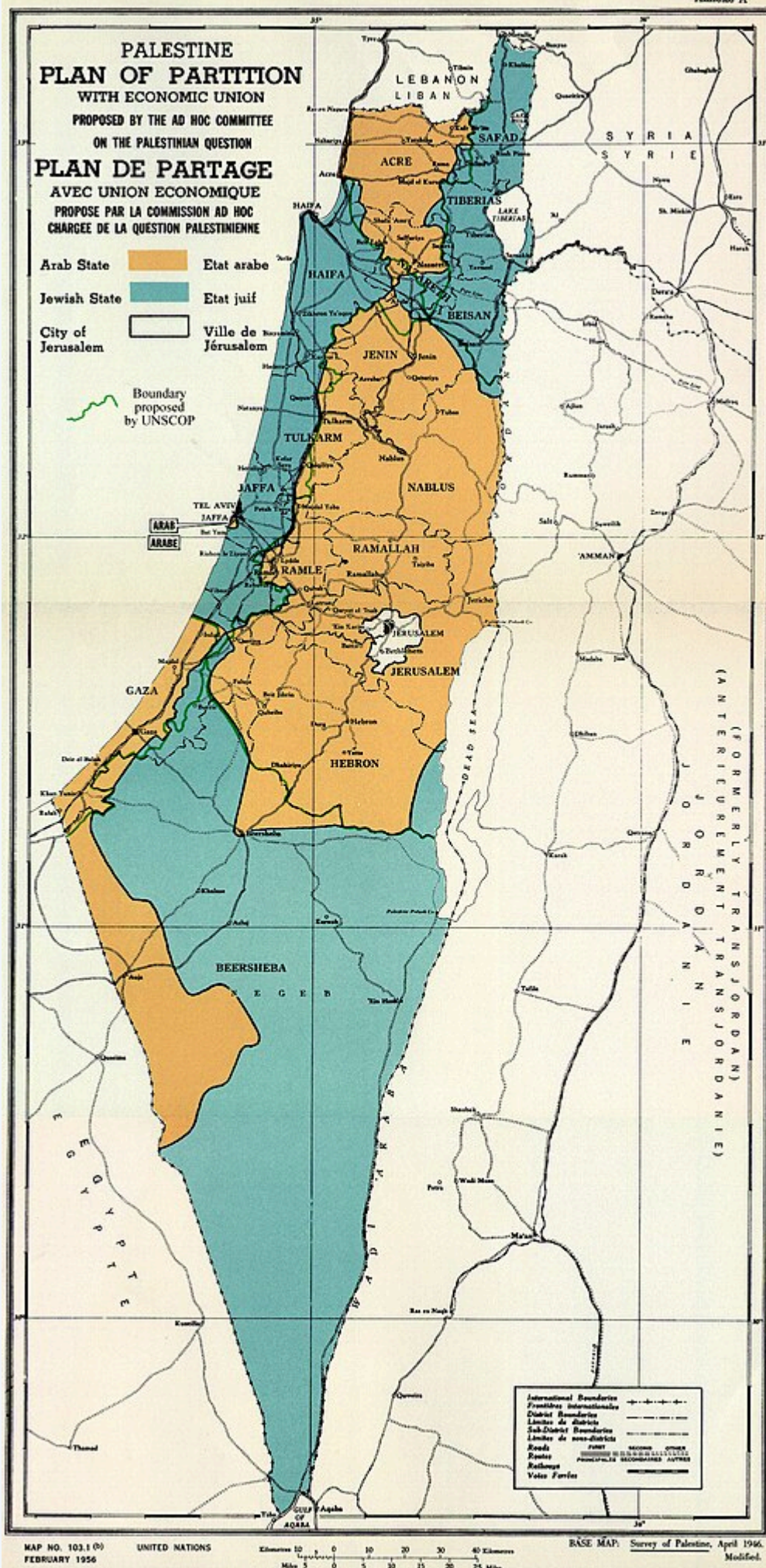
Style: Vocabulary Mapping

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Mandate | Zionism | Irgun | Nakba

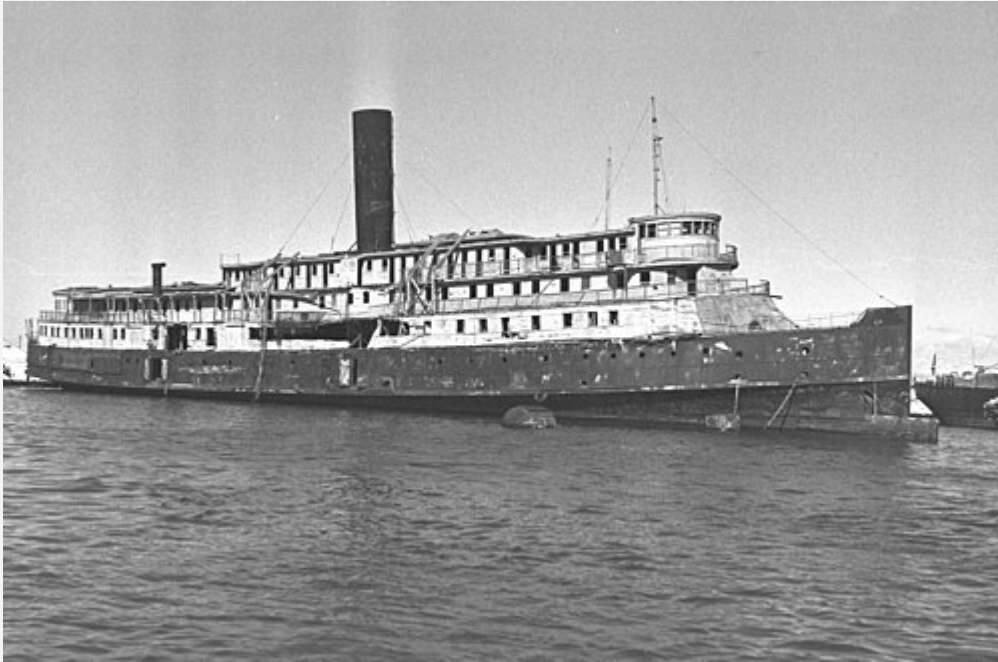
Your Sentence:

UN Partition Plan for Palestine (1947)



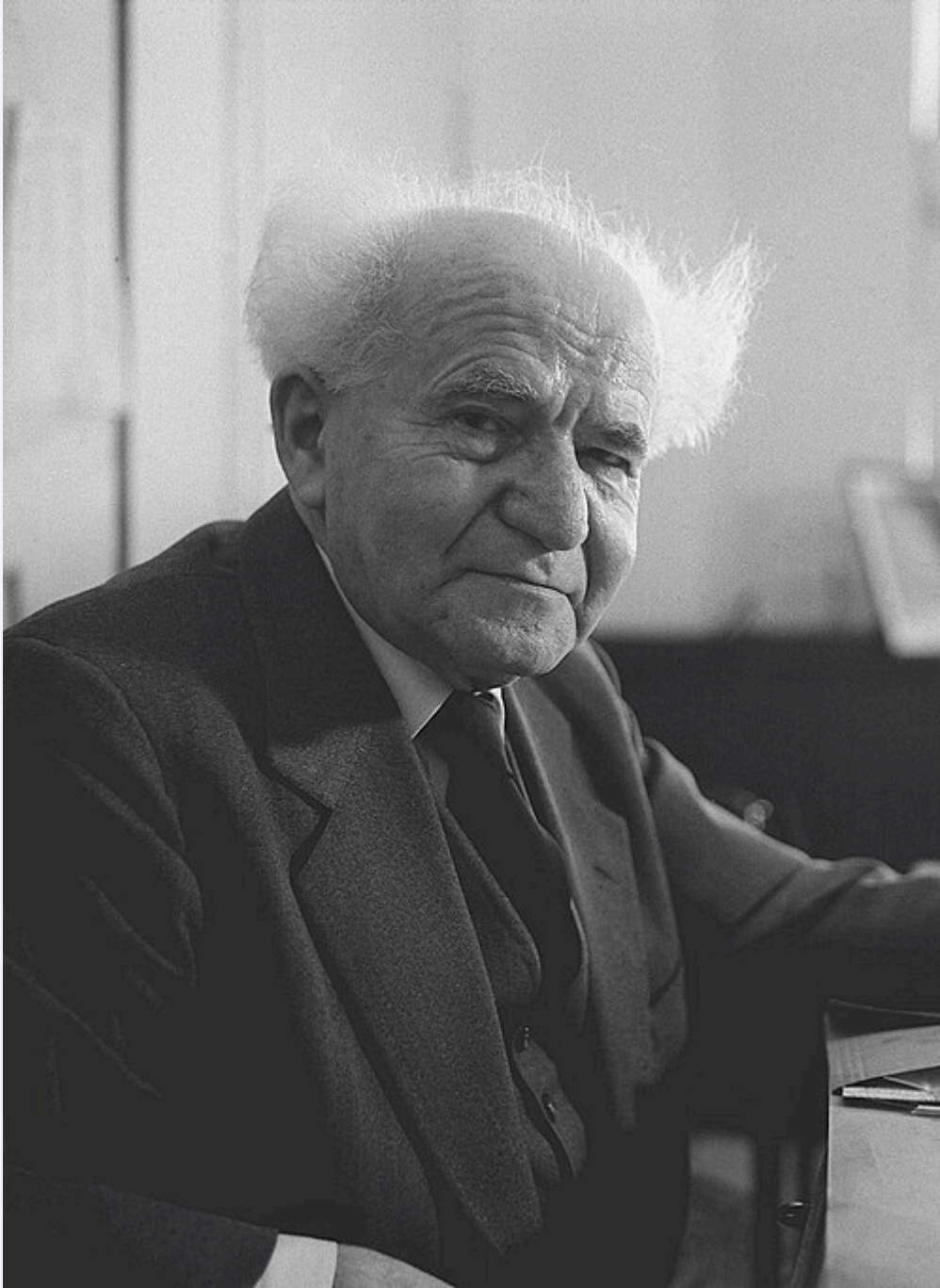
The proposed UN Partition Plan dividing Palestine into independent Arab and Jewish states, which was rejected by Arab leadership.

The SS Exodus (1947)



Jewish Holocaust survivors aboard the SS Exodus, turned away from Palestine by the British, sparking global outrage.

David Ben-Gurion declaring Independence (1948)



David Ben-Gurion declaring the establishment of the State of Israel on May 14, 1948.

Following the end of the Second World War in 1945, Great Britain found itself trapped in an increasingly untenable position within its League of Nations Mandate of Palestine. Under the terms of the Mandate, Britain was bound by a "dual obligation": on one hand, to establish a "national home" for the Jewish people (in line with the 1917 Balfour Declaration), and on the other, to safeguard the civil and religious rights of the existing Arab majority. As the full horrors of the Holocaust were revealed to the world, the international pressure for Jewish statehood became immense. In 1945, Zionist leaders gathered at a conference in London to demand the immediate creation of a Jewish state in Palestine, hoping that Britain would facilitate the resettlement of hundreds of thousands of Holocaust survivors currently languishing in European Displaced Persons (DP) camps.

Q2. What was the 'dual obligation' that Britain faced under the League of Nations Mandate of Palestine?

However, the Arab population—who formed the clear majority of Palestine's inhabitants—vehemently opposed this prospect. They resented not being granted independence at the end of the First World War and were furious that they had never been consulted regarding the mass resettlement of another population on their ancestral lands, which they had inhabited for over 1,500 years. Britain's newly elected Labour government, led by Prime Minister Clement Attlee and Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin, immediately faced a crisis. Bevin set a strict immigration quota of just 1,500 Jewish immigrants per month. He did this for two primary reasons: 1. He calculated that allowing a massive influx of Jewish refugees would trigger an uncontrollable civil war between Arabs and Jews. 2. Britain was economically dependent on maintaining close, friendly relations with oil-rich Arab states across the Middle East. These states strongly opposed Zionist ambitions and would not tolerate unrestricted Jewish immigration.

Q3. Identify two reasons why Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin set a strict immigration quota of 1,500 Jewish immigrants per month.

Angered by Bevin's strict immigration restrictions, Zionist organizations in Palestine abandoned the wartime truce they had maintained with the British. In October 1945, the moderate militia (the Haganah) joined forces with extreme paramilitary splinter groups—the Irgun (led by Menachem Begin) and the Lehi (also known as the Stern Gang). Together, they launched a coordinated, violent campaign known as the Jewish Insurgency to force a British withdrawal. While the moderate Haganah focused primarily on organizing illegal immigration (such as bringing Holocaust survivors on ships like the SS Exodus), the Irgun and Lehi targeted British military infrastructure. On 1 November 1945, the unified factions executed the Night of the Trains, blowing up the Palestine railway system in 153 places to paralyze British communications.

Q4. What was the 'Jewish Insurgency' and which three Zionist groups united to launch it?

Over the next two years, the insurgency intensified. Paramilitary groups bombed bridges, sabotaged oil pipelines, raided military airfields, destroyed radio stations, and assassinated British personnel. In 1946 alone, 73 British troops were killed. To destroy British military morale, Begin's Irgun engaged in psychological warfare; when two Irgun members were sentenced to caning in December 1946, Begin ordered the kidnapping and public whipping of four British soldiers in retaliation. The single deadliest act of the insurgency occurred on 22 July 1946, when the Irgun bombed the King David Hotel in Jerusalem. The hotel's southern wing housed the central administrative headquarters of the British Mandate and the military command of the British Army in Palestine. Under the cover of midday deliveries, Irgun fighters disguised as Arab workers rolled milk churns packed with TNT into the basement kitchen of the southern wing.

Q5. Describe the deadliest act of the insurgency on 22 July 1946 and explain its intended target.

At 12:37 PM, a colossal explosion ripped through the building, causing the entire six-story southern wing to collapse into rubble. The attack killed 91 people—including 41 Arabs, 28 British officials, 17 Jews, and several other nationalities. The vast majority of the victims were innocent civilians. The sheer scale of the carnage shocked the British public and drew fierce international condemnation, driving a permanent wedge between the moderate Haganah (who condemned the attack) and the militant Irgun. By early 1947, Britain was buckling under the financial and human cost of policing the Mandate, requiring over 100,000 troops to maintain a fragile grip on order. The boiling point of British public tolerance was reached in July 1947 during the 'Sergeants Affair'. In retaliation for the British execution of three Irgun militants, the Irgun kidnapped two young British intelligence sergeants. Despite desperate pleas from their families and a massive manhunt, the Irgun hanged both men and suspended their booby-trapped bodies in an olive grove.

Q6. How did the British public react to the 'Sergeants Affair', and what was the political result?

The public reaction in Britain was explosive. Angry anti-Semitic riots erupted in major British cities. Faced with a war-weary public demanding that the government 'bring the boys home,' Prime Minister Attlee and Foreign Secretary Bevin admitted that Palestine had become ungovernable. Unable to find a compromise that satisfied both Jewish and Arab demands, Britain formally referred the entire problem to the newly created United Nations (UN) in February 1947. The United Nations Special Committee on Palestine (UNSCOP) concluded that the only viable solution was the partition of the territory into separate Jewish and Arab states, with Jerusalem administered as an international zone (corpus separatum) under UN control. On 29 November 1947, the UN General Assembly voted on Resolution 181. The US and Soviet Union both supported partition, hoping to expand their own influence.

Q7. How did the United Nations Partition Plan (Resolution 181) divide the land of Palestine, and what was the reaction of the two communities?

The final vote was 33 in favor, 13 against, and 10 abstentions. Under Resolution 181, the Jewish population (which owned less than 10% of the land and made up only one-third of the population) was allocated 55% of Palestine, including the fertile coastal plains. The Arab majority was allocated just 45% of the land, much of it mountainous and fragmented. While the Zionist leadership accepted the plan with joy, Arab leaders and the Arab League rejected it, declaring that they would fight to prevent the partition of their homeland. The passage of Resolution 181 acted as the catalyst for immediate violence. In December 1947, Britain announced that it would formally terminate its Mandate and withdraw all forces on 15 May 1948. For the remaining five months, British troops stood aside and refused to intervene, leaving Palestine to slide into a bloody, chaotic civil war between Jewish and Arab communities.

In March 1948, the leadership of the Haganah implemented Plan Dalet (Plan D). Many historians argue that Plan D was a defensive military strategy designed to secure the borders of the future Jewish state by taking control of all Arab towns. Other historians argue that Plan D was an offensive operation that intentionally cleared Arab populations from strategic areas, effectively paving the way for the systematic ethnic cleansing of Palestine.

The most critical flashpoint of the civil war occurred on 9 April 1948, when approximately 100 fighters from the extremist Irgun and Lehi launched an assault on Deir Yassin, a quiet Arab village. The attack resulted in the brutal massacre of over 100 Arab villagers. Hoping to rally the Arab world to intervene, Arab radio stations broadcast sensationalized, graphic accounts of the atrocities at Deir Yassin. However, this triggered widespread, uncontrollable panic among the Arab population. Believing that they would face the same brutal fate if they stayed, over 250,000 Palestinian Arabs abandoned their homes and fled in terror.

Q8. What was the impact of the Deir Yassin massacre on the Palestinian Arab population in April 1948?

On 14 May 1948, the last British troops departed Palestine. That afternoon, David Ben-Gurion stood in Tel Aviv and officially declared the birth of the sovereign State of Israel. The very next day, on 15 May 1948, five sovereign Arab nations—Egypt, Syria, Jordan, Lebanon, and Iraq—committed their armies to a coordinated invasion of the newly declared state, launching the first official Arab-Israeli War. At the outset, the survival of Israel hung in the balance. Jewish forces were heavily outnumbered, short of heavy weaponry, and faced a multi-front assault. By June, both sides were exhausted, and on 11 June 1948, the United Nations intervened, brokering a crucial one-month truce managed by UN mediator Count Folke Bernadotte.

Israel used this one-month breathing space with exceptional efficiency. Prime Minister David Ben-Gurion dissolved the independent paramilitary groups and unified them into a single, professional national army: the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF). In direct violation of the UN weapons embargo, Israel used massive financial donations to purchase modern military hardware from Soviet-controlled Czechoslovakia, completely neutralizing the Arabs' initial material superiority. When the truce expired on 9 July 1948, the newly equipped IDF immediately went on the offensive, catching the Arab forces completely by surprise. In October 1948, Israel breached the second truce to launch its final offensives. Exhausted and politically divided, the Arab states signed separate Armistice Agreements with Israel between February and July 1949.

Q9. Describe the tactical advantage Israel gained during the first UN truce in June 1948.

The armistice borders of 1949, known as the 'Green Line,' fundamentally redrew the political map. Instead of the 55% allocated under the UN Partition Plan, Israel's victory secured control of 79% of mandate Palestine. An independent Palestinian Arab state ceased to exist. Over 700,000 Palestinians were permanently displaced from their homes, becoming refugees in neighboring states. The historical narrative of this displacement remains deeply contested. Traditional Israeli historiography argued that Palestinians left voluntarily under the orders of Arab leaders who promised they could return after the Jews were defeated. Conversely, Palestinian historians, and later Israeli 'New Historians' utilizing declassified IDF archives, demonstrated that the vast majority were driven out by a combination of deliberate military expulsion (such as Plan Dalet), psychological warfare, and the terror induced by massacres like Deir Yassin. For the Palestinian people, the loss of their homeland and the subsequent refugee crisis is known as the Nakba ('The Catastrophe').

Q10. Explain the conflicting historical views regarding the displacement of over 700,000 Palestinians during the 1948 war.

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: If you were the British government in 1945, exhausted by WWII and facing attacks from Jewish paramilitaries, what would you have done with the Mandate?

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: The Debate over Plan Dalet

Historians sharply disagree on the nature of Plan D. Traditional Israeli historians argue it was a purely defensive necessity to secure besieged Jewish settlements before the Arab armies invaded. However, 'New Historians' like Ilan Pappé argue the text of Plan D proves it was a deliberate blueprint for the systematic ethnic cleansing of Palestinian Arabs from the future Jewish state.

GCSE Exam Practice

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of 1945–48 which led to the creation of Israel. (8 marks)

Planning your narrative account:

Remember to link your paragraphs chronologically. You could use these sentence starters:

- *The first key event was...*
- *This directly led to...*
- *Consequently, this triggered...*
- *This situation culminated in...*

Handwriting practice lines for the narrative account.

Exam Practice

1. Explain the importance of conflicting interests and demands of Arabs and Jews for the British Mandate. 1945-48. (8 marks)

2. Explain the importance of the bombing of the King David Hotel (1946) for the ending of the British Mandate in 1947. (8 marks)

4. Explain one consequence of growing Jewish insurgency during the British Mandate 1946-1947. (4 marks)

3. Write a narrative account analysing the conflicting interests and demands of Arabs and Jews in the British Mandate 1945-47. (8 marks)

5. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of 1946-48 that led to the creation of Israel. (8 marks)

6. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Arab-Israeli war from 1948 to 1949. (8 marks)

Documentary / General Notes

Title / Topic: _____

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

KT1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the territorial changes and their impact, including the refugee status of Palestinian Arabs.
- ☐ Understand the creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) and the Law of Return (1950), and the importance of US aid to Israel.
- ☐ Analyze Israel's relations with Egypt in the aftermath of the war.

The moment Israel declared independence on 14 May 1948, five Arab armies invaded. What followed was a desperate fight for survival for the Israelis, and a catastrophic loss of land for the Palestinians—an event they remember as the 'Nakba' (Catastrophe). The map of the Middle East was forever redrawn.

Did you know?

- 700,000: The approximate number of Palestinian Arabs who fled or were expelled from their homes during the war.
- 78%: The amount of Mandatory Palestine that Israel controlled by the end of the war, far more than the UN Partition Plan.
- 1949: Armistice agreements were signed, but no Arab state officially recognised Israel's right to exist.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. In what month and year did the British Mandate officially end and the State of Israel get declared?

2. Which extreme Jewish paramilitary group carried out the bombing of the King David Hotel in July 1946?

3. What was the name of the British Foreign Secretary who ultimately decided to hand the Palestine Mandate over to the United Nations in 1947?

4. Under UN Resolution 181 (the 1947 Partition Plan), what percentage of Palestine was allocated to the proposed Jewish state, and what was to be the status of Jerusalem?

5. Give two reasons why the Arab League and Palestinian leaders rejected UN Resolution 181.

6. What was 'Plan Dalet' (Plan D), implemented by the Haganah in March 1948, and why is it a subject of intense historical debate?

7. Name the five sovereign Arab states that launched a coordinated invasion of Israel on 15 May 1948.

8. Explain how the first UN-brokered truce (starting 11 June 1948) changed the military balance of the 1948 War in Israel's favor.

9. Explain the significance of the Deir Yassin massacre (April 1948) for the subsequent Palestinian flight.

10. In a narrative account of the end of the British Mandate, how would you link the bombing of the King David Hotel to UN Resolution 181?

Vocabulary Check

Style: Mini-Frayer Model

Complete the Frayer Model for the term: **Green Line**

Definition	Historical Example
Non-Example / Sketch	Your own sentence

The 1948 Arab-Israeli War



Forces engaged in combat during the 1948 Arab-Israeli War, which Israel calls the War of Independence.

Palestinian Refugees (The Nakba)



Palestinian refugees fleeing their homes during the 1948 war, an event known in Arabic as the Nakba (Catastrophe).

UNRWA Refugee Camps

 Source

Palestinian refugees displaced by the 1948 war, who would later be supported by UNRWA.

The signing of separate Armistice Agreements between Israel and its Arab neighbors (Egypt in February, Lebanon in March, Transjordan in April, and Syria in July 1949) formally ended the military hostilities of the first Arab-Israeli War but left a highly volatile political landscape. The armistice lines, drawn in green ink on the negotiators' maps and thereafter referred to as the 'Green Line,' fundamentally redrew the geography of the

Middle East. Rather than the 55% of mandate Palestine allocated under the 1947 UN Partition Plan, Israel's military victory secured control over 75% to 79% of the territory, including the fertile coastal plains, the Galilee, the Negev Desert, and a secure corridor to West Jerusalem.

The remaining portions of mandate Palestine were occupied by neighboring Arab states, entirely preventing the creation of an independent Palestinian Arab state. The West Bank and East Jerusalem were occupied and subsequently annexed by King Abdullah of Transjordan, a unilateral move designed to expand his Hashemite kingdom that was widely condemned as illegal by the rest of the Arab world. Meanwhile, the Gaza Strip—a narrow coastal territory crowded with displaced refugees—was placed under the military and administrative control of Egypt. Jerusalem itself was left deeply divided, with barbed wire, concrete walls, and military checkpoints separating Israeli-controlled West Jerusalem from Jordanian-controlled East Jerusalem.

Q1. What happened to the remaining portions of mandate Palestine (the West Bank and Gaza Strip) following the 1948-49 war?

For Palestinian Arabs, the immediate aftermath of the war was a tragedy of historic proportions, remembered as the Nakba ('The Catastrophe'). Approximately 700,000 Palestinian Arabs—representing over half of the Arab population of mandate Palestine—were permanently displaced from their ancestral homes. These refugees fled or were forcibly expelled by advancing Jewish forces during the fighting, seeking safety in the neighboring territories of Jordan, Syria, Lebanon, the West Bank, and the Gaza Strip. To cope with this vast humanitarian emergency, the United Nations General Assembly established the United Nations Relief and Works Agency (UNRWA) in December 1949. UNRWA constructed and managed dozens of temporary refugee camps, providing basic food rations, emergency tents, rudimentary healthcare, and elementary schooling.

Q2. How did the United Nations attempt to cope with the vast humanitarian emergency created by the displacement of 700,000 Palestinian Arabs?

Despite the end of the war, a permanent resolution to the crisis was blocked by deep political divisions. Israel strictly denied the Palestinians their 'right of return' to their former homes. The Israeli government argued that allowing hundreds of thousands of hostile Arab refugees to return would destroy the Jewish majority, compromise national security, and undermine the sovereign Jewish character of the state. Conversely, the Arab host states (with the exception of Jordan) refused to grant the refugees citizenship or integrate them into their national societies. They insisted that the camps must remain intact to prevent the international community from forgetting the Palestinian issue and to keep permanent diplomatic and moral pressure on Israel to honor the right of return. As a result, generations of Palestinians were left stranded in squalid, overcrowded camps, suffering from poor sanitation, deep economic poverty, and a permanent lack of civil rights.

Q3. Why did both Israel and the Arab host states refuse to permanently integrate the Palestinian refugees into their societies?

Faced with permanent hostility from its neighbors, the fledgling State of Israel focused intensely on consolidating its security and building up its population. On 26 May 1948, Prime Minister David Ben-Gurion issued a decree officially establishing the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF). This measure was highly significant because it systematically dismantled and banned the independent paramilitary groups (the Haganah, the Irgun, and the Lehi) that had operated during the British Mandate and the civil war, unifying them under a single, highly professional state command. The creation of the IDF gave Israel a powerful national army capable of defending its highly vulnerable borders against future Arab invasions. To bolster national security, Israel implemented a system of compulsory military conscription for its citizens, transforming the state into a highly mobilized 'nation in arms'.

Q4. Why was the establishment of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) in May 1948 highly significant for Israel's internal politics and national security?

To solve its demographic vulnerability, the Israeli Knesset passed the Law of Return in July 1950. This landmark legislation declared that any Jew anywhere in the world had the legal right to immigrate to Israel and secure immediate, automatic citizenship. This policy triggered an immense demographic boom, doubling Israel's population within just a few years. The influx included hundreds of thousands of Holocaust survivors from Europe and Jewish refugees expelled from Arab nations across the Middle East who had lost their properties and livelihoods. Although the massive wave of immigration strained Israel's fragile housing and food supplies, it was highly important because it provided a massive, determined workforce to develop the economy and supplied the IDF with a constant stream of military manpower to protect the state.

Q5. Explain the demographic impact of the 1950 Law of Return on the new State of Israel.

In its early years, Israel faced severe economic crises that threatened to collapse the state from within. The young country had to fund a massive military defense budget, build housing for hundreds of thousands of destitute immigrants arriving under the Law of Return, and survive a total economic boycott implemented by the Arab League, which banned all trade with Israel and penalised foreign companies that did business with the Jewish state. In this precarious position, direct financial and political aid from the United States was absolutely critical to Israel's survival. President Harry Truman, driven by strong domestic sympathy for Holocaust survivors and intense political lobbying, quickly recognized Israel and authorized massive emergency loans and grants.

Q6. Why did President Harry Truman authorise massive emergency loans and grants to Israel in its early years?

These funds allowed the Israeli government to buy food, build infrastructure, establish agricultural settlements, and import vital materials to industrialize the country. This early financial pipeline established a powerful strategic relationship between the United States and Israel, which deepened as Cold War rivalries intensified in the Middle East. The 1949 armistice did not lead to a lasting peace, and relations between Israel and its most powerful neighbor, Egypt, remained intensely hostile. Egypt refused to recognize Israel's right to exist and took active measures to strangle the new state economically and militarily.

Egypt closed the internationally vital Suez Canal to all Israeli ships and systematically searched neutral vessels, confiscating any cargo purchased at Israeli ports or bound for Israel's armed forces. Furthermore, from 1951, Egyptian forces established a permanent military blockade at the Straits of Tiran (Sharm el-Sheikh), stopping all foreign cargo vessels heading toward Israel's southern port of Eilat, completely choking Israeli trade with Asia and East Africa. Egypt also utilized the Gaza Strip—which it controlled—as a launchpad for Fedayeen (Palestinian guerrilla) raids. These displaced refugees launched cross-border attacks into Israel to sabotage infrastructure, steal livestock, and kill Jewish civilians.

Q7. Describe two ways that Egypt attempted to strangle Israel economically and militarily in the early 1950s.

To counter this threat, David Ben-Gurion implemented a severe reprisal policy, ordering the IDF to respond to every border raid with disproportionate military force against Egyptian military posts to deter future attacks. This created a violent, escalating border war that kept the region on the brink of conflict. This border tension escalated dramatically in July 1952, when the corrupt and pro-Western King Farouk of Egypt was overthrown in a military coup by the Free Officers Movement. This coup eventually brought the charismatic and fiercely anti-Western Colonel Gamal Abdel Nasser to power in Egypt. Nasser's championing of Pan-Arabism and his determination to avenge the Arab defeat of 1948 made him the undisputed leader of the Arab world, setting Egypt and Israel on a direct collision course that would culminate in the 1956 Suez Crisis.

Q8. How did David Ben-Gurion attempt to deter Fedayeen border raids, and what was the consequence?

Q9. Explain one consequence of the territorial changes following the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli war. (4 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Why do you think the well-equipped Arab armies were defeated by the newly formed Israeli Defense Forces?

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Explain one consequence of the territorial changes following the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli war. (4 marks)

Exam Practice

1. Explain one consequence of the 1948-49 Arab-Israeli War. (4 marks)

2. Explain the importance of the Arab-Israeli conflict of 1948 for relations between Palestinians and Israelis. (8 marks)

3. Write a narrative account analysing the growth of Israel 1949-1954. (8 marks)

4. Explain the importance of US aid to Israel for the consolidation of the new state in the years 1949-54. (8 marks)

5. Explain the importance of Israel's early relations with Egypt for the stability of the region in the years 1949-54. (8 marks)

Documentary / General Notes

Title / Topic: _____

- ☐ Emerging (1-2)
- ☐ Emerging+ (3)
- ☐ Expected (4-5)
- ☐ Expected+ (6-7)
- ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

KT1.3: Increased Tension, 1955–1963

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.
- ☐ Analyze the events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956.
- ☐ Evaluate the events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958.

By the 1950s, the Cold War had arrived in the Middle East. Egypt's charismatic new leader, Gamal Abdel Nasser, emerged as a hero of Arab nationalism, willing to stand up to the old European empires and Israel. When he nationalised the Suez Canal, it triggered a global crisis that almost sparked World War Three.

Did you know?

- 1956: Nasser nationalised the Suez Canal, taking it back from British and French control.
- Protocol of Sèvres: A secret agreement where Israel, Britain, and France planned to invade Egypt together.
- Superpower Intervention: The US and Soviet Union forced Britain, France, and Israel to withdraw, humiliating the old empires.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. What is the historical name given to the 1949 armistice line that established Israel's borders after its victory in the first Arab-Israeli War?

2. Which neighbouring Arab country occupied and annexed the West Bank and East Jerusalem following the 1948–49 war?

3. What Arabic term, meaning "The Catastrophe," do Palestinians use to describe the 1948–49 war and its immediate consequences?

4. Approximately how many Palestinian Arabs became refugees as a result of the 1948–49 war, and what agency was set up by the UN in December 1949 to support them?

5. Give one reason why Israel strictly denied Palestinian refugees the "right of return," and one reason why Arab host states (except Jordan) refused to permanently integrate these refugees.

6. Explain the twofold significance of the Law of Return, passed by the Israeli Knesset in July 1950.

7. What was the value of the vital economic grant given to Israel by the US government in 1949, and what was the further amount provided by 1960?

8. Describe the two primary ways Egypt chose to economically choke the State of Israel in the years immediately following the 1949 armistice.

9. What were the Fedayeen, and how did Israel's official reprisal policy under David Ben-Gurion attempt to deal with them?

10. Write an analytical sentence linking the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War to the creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF).

Vocabulary Check

Style: Contextual Cloze

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Pan-Arabism | Czech Arms Deal | Nationalisation | Protocol of Sèvres | UNEF

Driven by the ideology of _____, Gamal Abdel Nasser sought to modernize Egypt. Following the _____, the West refused to fund his dam project. In retaliation, Nasser announced the _____ of the Suez Canal. This led to the secret _____ where Israel, Britain, and France invaded Egypt. The conflict ended with the deployment of _____ peacekeepers in the Sinai.

Gamal Abdel Nasser



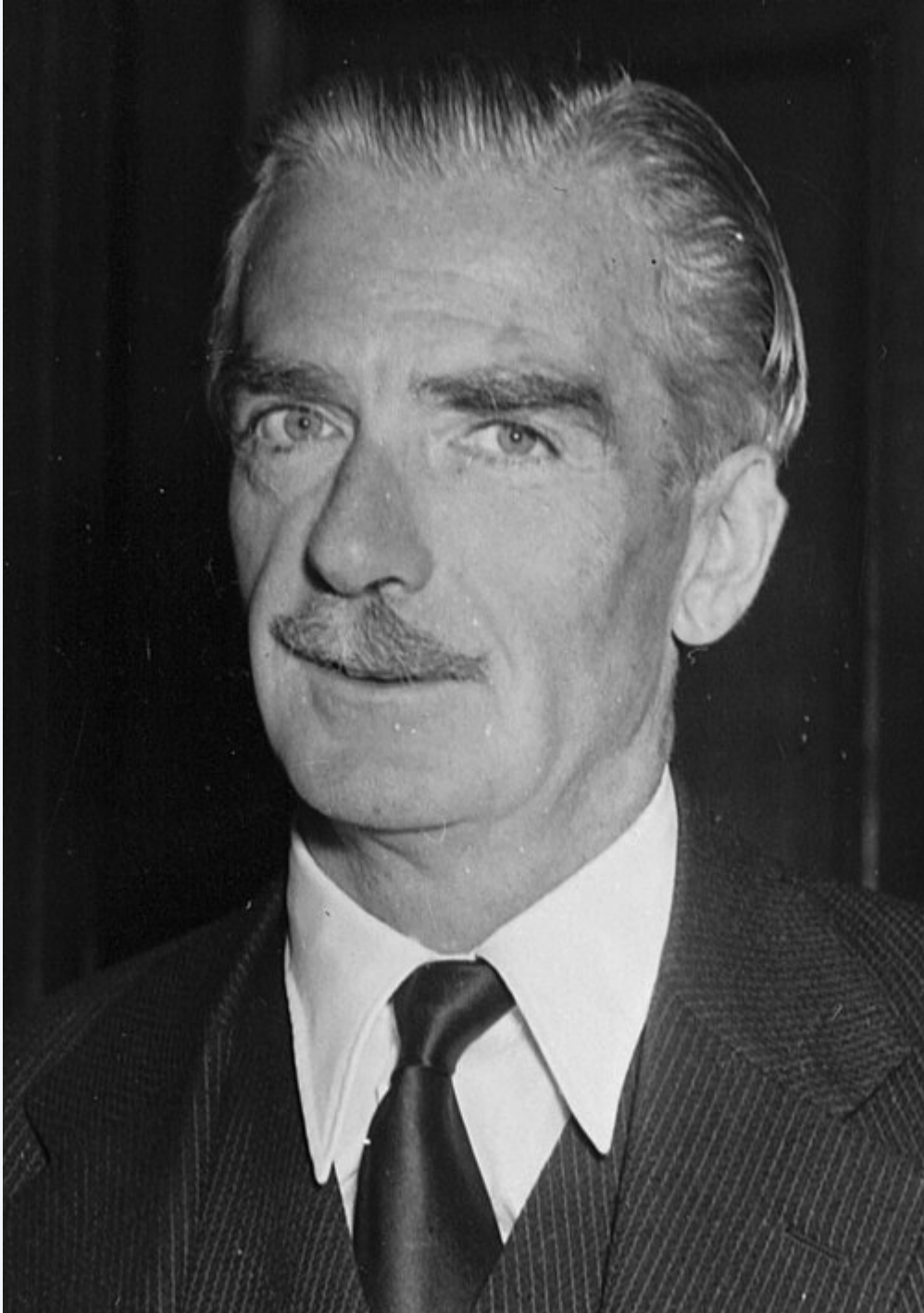
Egyptian President Gamal Abdel Nasser, whose Pan-Arab nationalism deeply challenged Western and Israeli interests.

The Suez Crisis (1956)



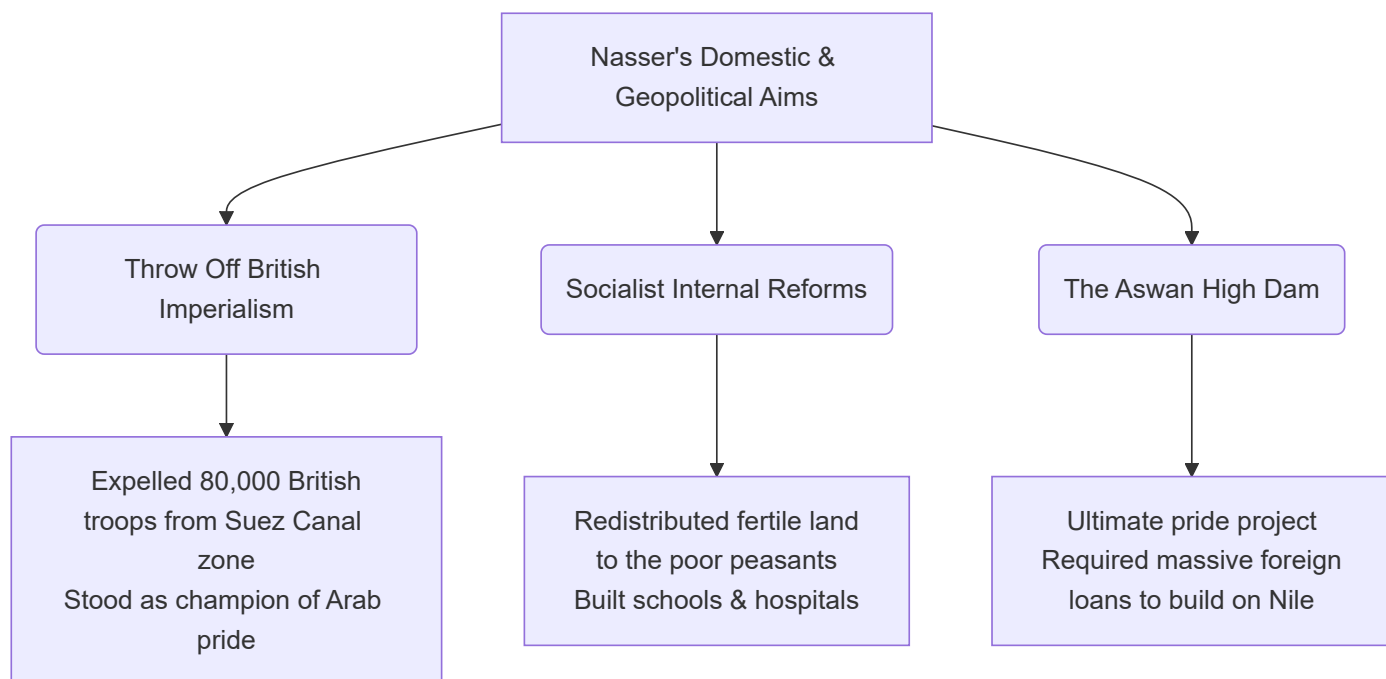
Port Said during the Suez Crisis, when Britain, France, and Israel launched a coordinated attack on Egypt.

Anthony Eden



British Prime Minister Anthony Eden (center), whose career was ruined by the failure of the Suez intervention.

The fragile status quo established by the 1949 armistice was permanently shattered by political upheavals inside Egypt. In July 1952, a group of nationalist army officers known as the "Free Officers Movement" overthrew Egypt's corrupt, pro-Western monarch, King Farouk. By 1954, the charismatic and fiercely anti-imperialist Colonel Gamal Abdel Nasser emerged as the undisputed President of Egypt. Nasser quickly positioned himself as the champion of Pan-Arabism—a powerful political ideology aimed at uniting Arab nations to throw off Western colonial influence, secure Arab dignity, and avenge the humiliating 1948 defeat by Israel.



Nasser's immediate political objectives were both local and geopolitical. Although Egypt was technically independent, 80,000 British troops still occupied the strategically vital Suez Canal Zone. Nasser immediately placed heavy diplomatic pressure on Britain, successfully forcing them to sign an agreement to withdraw their forces by June 1956. Nasser initiated sweeping domestic reforms to help the poor Egyptian peasants (fellahin), including the redistribution of agricultural land and the construction of thousands of state schools and clinics.

Q1. What were Gamal Abdel Nasser's immediate political and domestic objectives after taking power in Egypt?

The cornerstone of Nasser's developmental vision was the construction of a massive hydroelectric dam on the River Nile at Aswan. This monumental engineering project was designed to control the annual flooding of the Nile, provide clean electricity for industrialization, and irrigate millions of acres of desert land to feed Egypt's growing population. To fund this expensive project, Egypt required massive financial loans from Western powers, primarily the United States and Great Britain. Tensions between Egypt and Israel escalated dramatically on 28 February 1955 during the Gaza Raid. In retaliation for the ambush and murder of an Israeli civilian, Prime Minister David Ben-Gurion ordered the IDF to launch a massive reprisal raid against an Egyptian military headquarters in the Gaza Strip. The attack was devastating: IDF paratroopers blew up the garrison, killing 38 Egyptian soldiers and leaving Nasser's army thoroughly humiliated.

Q2. Why did Israel launch a devastating reprisal raid on the Gaza Strip on 28 February 1955, and what was the result?

1955 Gaza Raid Humiliates
Egypt

```
graph TD; A[1955 Gaza Raid Humiliates Egypt] --> B[Nasser Realises Military Weakness]; B --> C[1955 Czech Arms Deal Soviet Bloc]; C --> D[ ];
```

Nasser Realises Military
Weakness

1955 Czech Arms Deal
Soviet Bloc



**Egypt Receives Advanced
Jets/Tanks**

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graph TD; A[Egypt Receives Advanced Jets/Tanks] --> B[Western Alarm: US/UK Cancel Dam Loan]; B --> C[Nasser Nationalises Suez Canal];
```

**Western Alarm: US/UK
Cancel Dam Loan**

**Nasser Nationalises Suez
Canal**

The Gaza Raid served as a turning point for Nasser, proving that his forces were too weakly equipped to deter Israeli military power. When the United States refused to sell him weapons without political strings attached, Nasser turned to the Soviet bloc. In September 1955, Nasser stunned the West by signing the Czech Arms Deal. Under this agreement, Czechoslovakia (acting as a front for the Soviet Union) supplied Egypt with a massive arsenal of modern military hardware, including 200 advanced MiG-15 jet fighters, 300 modern tanks, and heavy artillery. This deal brought the Cold War directly into the heart of the Middle East, deeply alarming both Israel and the Western powers.

Q3. What was the significance of the 1955 Czech Arms Deal for the balance of power in the Middle East?

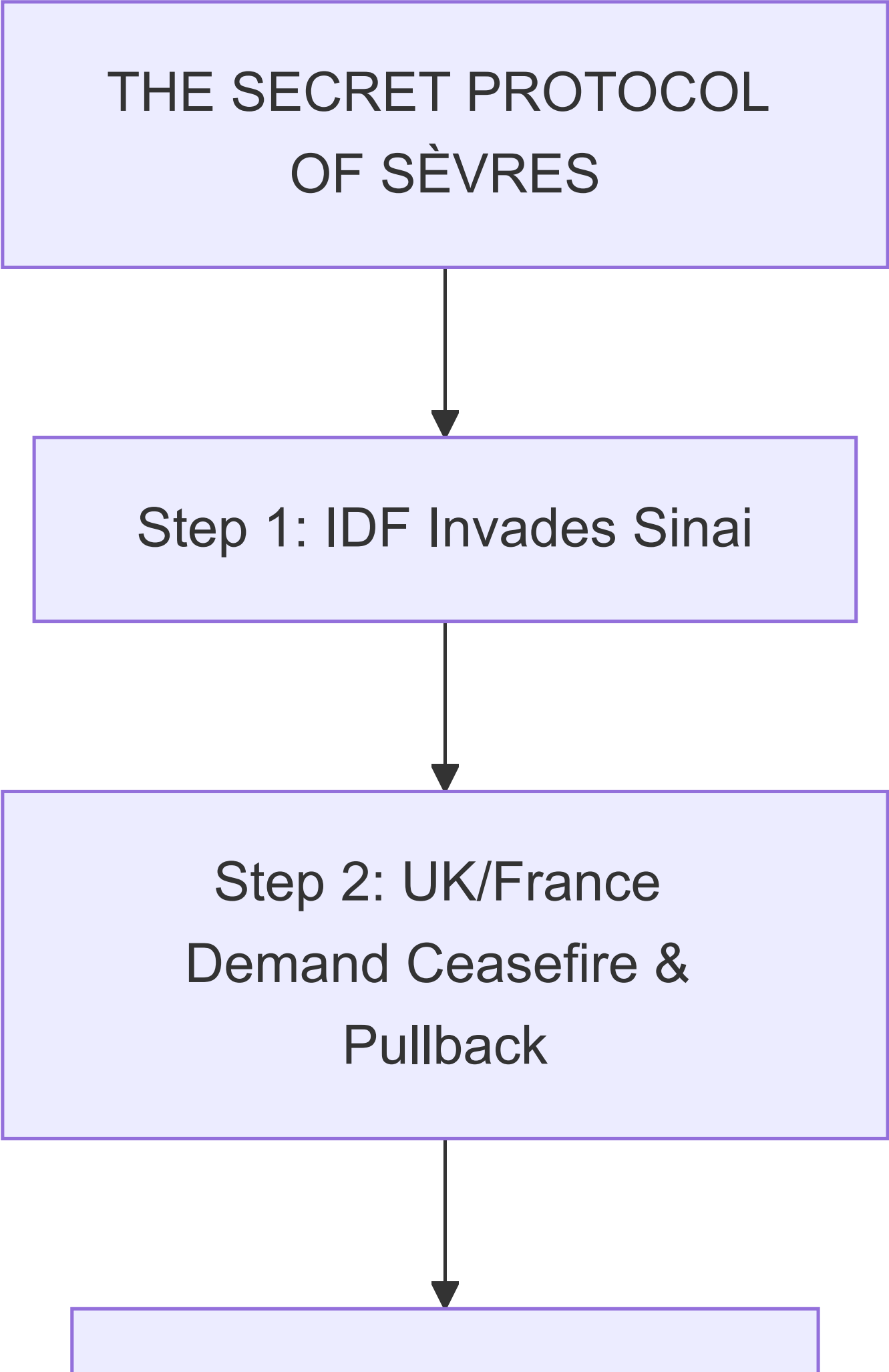
In response to Nasser's Soviet alignment and his continued support for Gaza-based Fedayeen raids (which killed 58 Israeli civilians in April 1956 alone), the United States and Great Britain took retaliatory economic action. In July 1956, they abruptly withdrew their joint offer to finance the Aswan High Dam. Nasser refused to let his pride project die. On 26 July 1956, he delivered a fiery speech in Alexandria and announced the nationalisation of the Suez Canal Company. He declared that Egypt would seize the canal from its British and French shareholders and use the £35 million annual toll revenues to directly fund the construction of the Aswan High Dam.

Q4. How did President Nasser respond when the United States and Great Britain abruptly withdrew their funding for the Aswan High Dam?

The nationalisation of the Suez Canal outraged Great Britain and France. British Prime Minister Anthony Eden viewed Nasser as a dangerous dictator who threatened Europe's vital oil supply line. Behind the scenes, Britain and France colluded with Israel to plan a military intervention to overthrow Nasser and retake the canal. This conspiracy was codified in the highly secret Protocol of Sèvres in October 1956.

Q5. What was the secret Protocol of Sèvres in October 1956?

THE SECRET PROTOCOL OF SÈVRES



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graph TD; A[THE SECRET PROTOCOL OF SÈVRES] --> B[Step 1: IDF Invades Sinai]; B --> C[Step 2: UK/France Demand Ceasefire & Pullback]; C --> D[ ]
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Step 1: IDF Invades Sinai

Step 2: UK/France
Demand Ceasefire &
Pullback



Step 3: Egypt Refuses



Step 4: Anglo-French Troops Occupy Canal to Protect It

Under this secret tripartite plan, Israel would launch a pre-emptive strike across the Sinai Desert toward the Suez Canal. Once hostilities began, Britain and France would issue an ultimatum to both sides to stop fighting and pull back ten miles from the canal. Knowing Egypt would refuse to abandon its own territory, Britain and France would then launch an air and sea invasion to occupy the Suez Canal Zone under the guise of "protecting" international shipping.

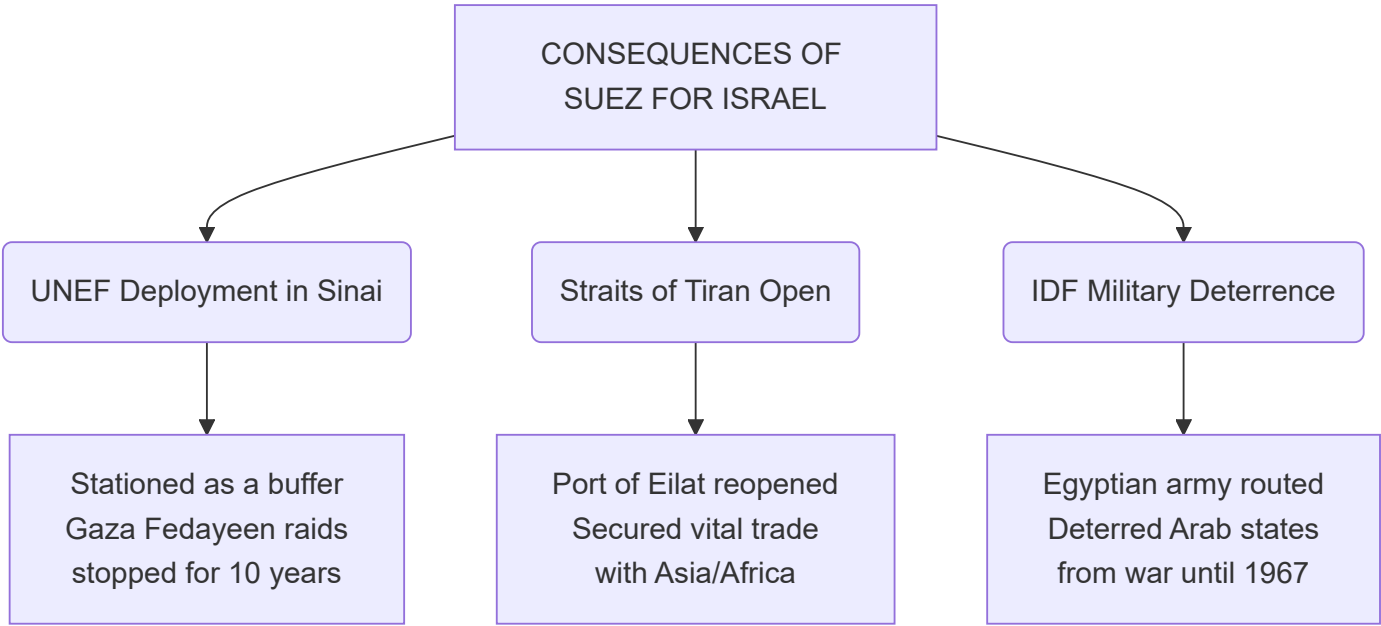
Q6. Explain how Britain and France planned to use an Israeli invasion of the Sinai as a pretext to retake the Suez Canal.

On 29 October 1956, the plan was put into action. The IDF launched a highly successful blitzkrieg across Sinai, routing the Egyptian army and advancing rapidly toward the canal. Britain and France immediately issued their pre-planned ultimatum and, as expected, launched heavy bombing raids and landed paratroopers at Port Said to seize control of the canal. The conspiracy backfired due to furious resistance from the global superpowers. Soviet leader Nikita Khrushchev threatened to launch nuclear missile strikes against London and Paris. More decisively, US President Dwight D. Eisenhower was outraged that his allies had launched a war without consulting him, fearing it would drive the entire Arab world into the arms of the USSR. Eisenhower applied massive economic pressure on Great Britain, threatening to refuse loans and block Britain's access to oil.

Q7. Why did the Anglo-French-Israeli conspiracy backfire and end in a humiliating retreat?

Buckling under American financial pressure, Britain and France were forced into a humiliating retreat, withdrawing their forces by December 1956. Israel, under intense US pressure, was forced to return the entire Sinai Peninsula to Egypt in early 1957. While the Suez Crisis was a political humiliation for Britain and France, it fundamentally transformed the security situation in the Middle East.

For Egypt and Nasser	For Israel's Security	For the Cold War
Nasser emerged from the crisis as an undisputed Arab folk hero . Although his army had been defeated on the battlefield, he had successfully stood up to British, French, and Israeli "imperialism" and kept control of the Suez Canal, cementing Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.	Israel scored massive military and strategic benefits. The IDF had proven its unquestioned military superiority , routing the Egyptian army in just a few days, which acted as a powerful deterrent against future Arab invasions.	The Middle East became a central theater of the Cold War. British and French colonial influence in the region was permanently broken, replaced by direct US support for Israel and Soviet backing for Egypt and Syria .



Crucially, Israel's forced withdrawal from the Sinai Peninsula was conditioned on three vital security guarantees. First, the United Nations deployed its first-ever peacekeeping force, the United Nations Emergency Force (UNEF), along the Gaza border and the Sinai Desert. This UNEF buffer successfully halted the Gaza Fedayeen raids, guaranteeing Israel ten years of relative border security. Second, the UNEF took control of Sharm el-Sheikh, forcing Egypt to lift its naval blockade. The Straits of Tiran were reopened to Israeli vessels, allowing Eilat to flourish as a vital trade port for oil, materials, and commerce with Asia and East Africa.

Q8. Identify two vital security guarantees Israel received in exchange for withdrawing its forces from the Sinai Peninsula.

Finally, the political momentum of Nasser's victory led directly to the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in February 1958—a total political and military union between Egypt and Syria. While this union increased Israeli fears of encirclement, it also locked the region into an uneasy, highly armed decade-long stalemate that lasted until 1967.

Q9. Explain one consequence of the nationalisation of the Suez Canal in 1956. (4 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Why was the Suez Canal so important to Britain and France that they were willing to go to war over it?

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

GCSE Exam Practice

Explain one consequence of the Suez Crisis (1956) for the Middle East. (4 marks)

Exam Practice

1. Explain the importance of Israeli attacks on Gaza, 1955, for relations between Egypt and Israel. (8 marks)

2. Explain one consequence of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955. (4 marks)

3. Explain one consequence of the Suez Canal Crisis (1956). (4 marks)

5. Explain one consequence of the formation of the United Arab Republic, UAR, in 1958. (4 marks)

4. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Suez Canal Crisis (1956). (8 marks)

6. Explain the importance of the formation of the United Arab Republic, UAR, in 1958 for regional tension in the Middle East. (8 marks)

Documentary / General Notes

Title / Topic: _____

- Teacher Comment:

KT2.1: The Six Day War, 1967

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the significance of the Cairo Conference (1964) and the growth of Fatah and the PLO.
- ☐ Analyze the escalating tension between Israel, Syria and Jordan: Syria's support for Fatah, Israel's raid on Samu and the events of 7 April 1967.
- ☐ Evaluate the actions of the USSR, Nasser and the USA in the period leading to war, and the key events of the war.

In June 1967, tensions reached a boiling point. Arab armies massed on Israel's borders, and fiery rhetoric promised Israel's destruction. But in a stunning, pre-emptive strike, Israel destroyed the entire Egyptian air force on the ground. In just six days, the geopolitical landscape of the region was completely transformed.

Did you know?

- **Pre-emptive Strike:** Israel launched Operation Focus, destroying over 300 Egyptian aircraft in a few hours.
- **Golan Heights:** Israel captured this strategic high ground from Syria, heavily fortifying its northern border.
- **Sinai Peninsula:** Israel conquered the vast Sinai desert, creating a huge buffer zone between themselves and Egypt.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. Who became the President of Egypt in 1954 and positioned himself as the leading champion of Pan-Arabism?

2. What was the name of the highly secret agreement signed in October 1956 where Britain, France, and Israel planned the tripartite invasion of Egypt?

3. Explain the immediate cause behind Nasser's decision to nationalise the Suez Canal Company on 26 July 1956.

4. What was the 1955 Gaza Raid, and why was it a turning point for Egyptian defense policy?

5. How did Nasser successfully bypass Western weapons restrictions in September 1955 to rearm Egypt?

Vocabulary Check

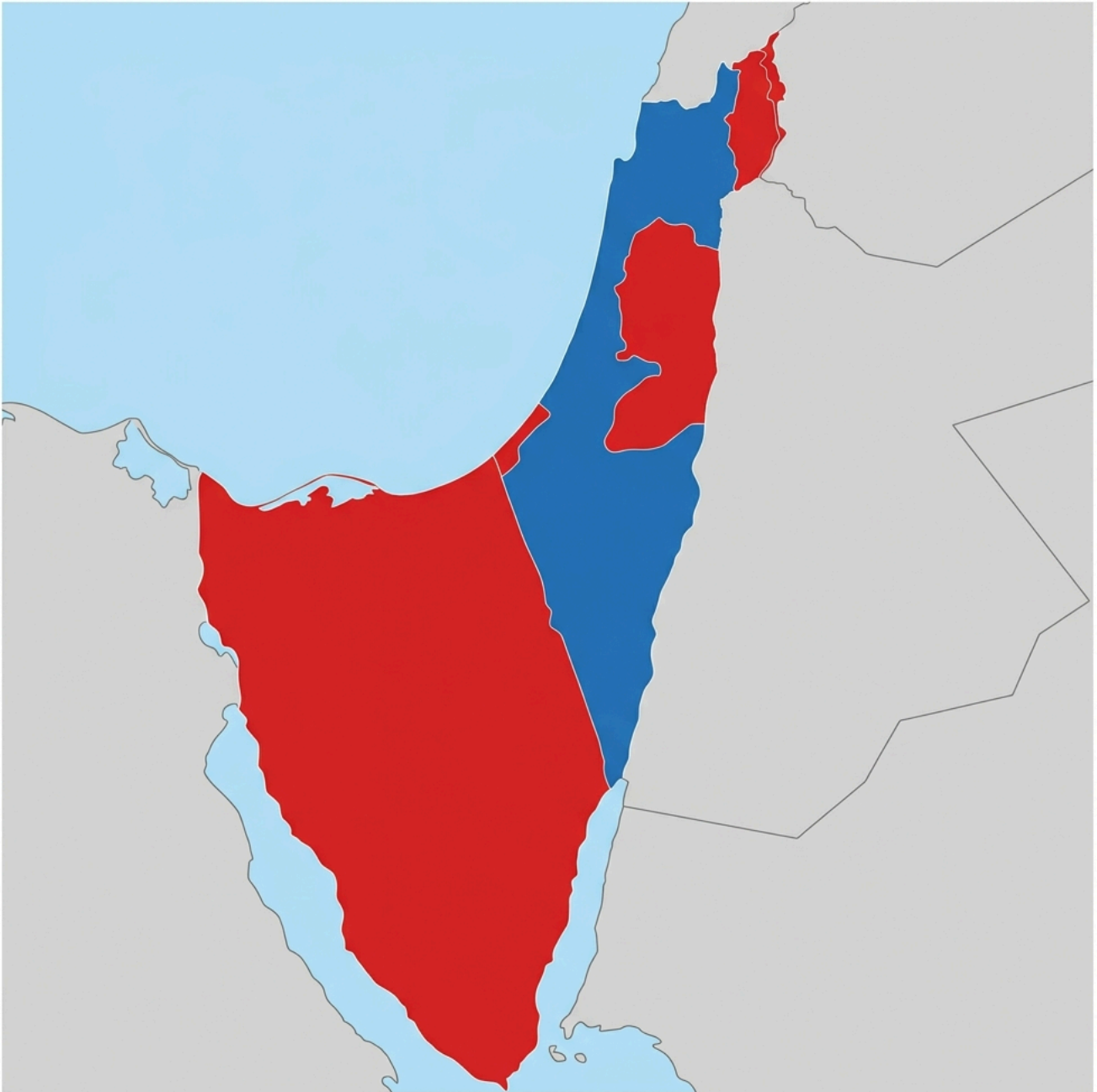
Style: Vocabulary Mapping

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

PLO (Palestine Liberation Organisation) | Fatah | Pre-emptive Strike | Casus Belli

Your Sentence:

The Six-Day War Map



Map detailing the massive territorial gains made by Israel during the Six-Day War.

Israeli Paratroopers at the Western Wall

 Source

Israeli paratroopers standing in awe at the Western Wall after capturing the Old City of Jerusalem.

Operation Focus

 Source

Israeli aircraft dominating the skies after destroying the Egyptian Air Force on the ground.

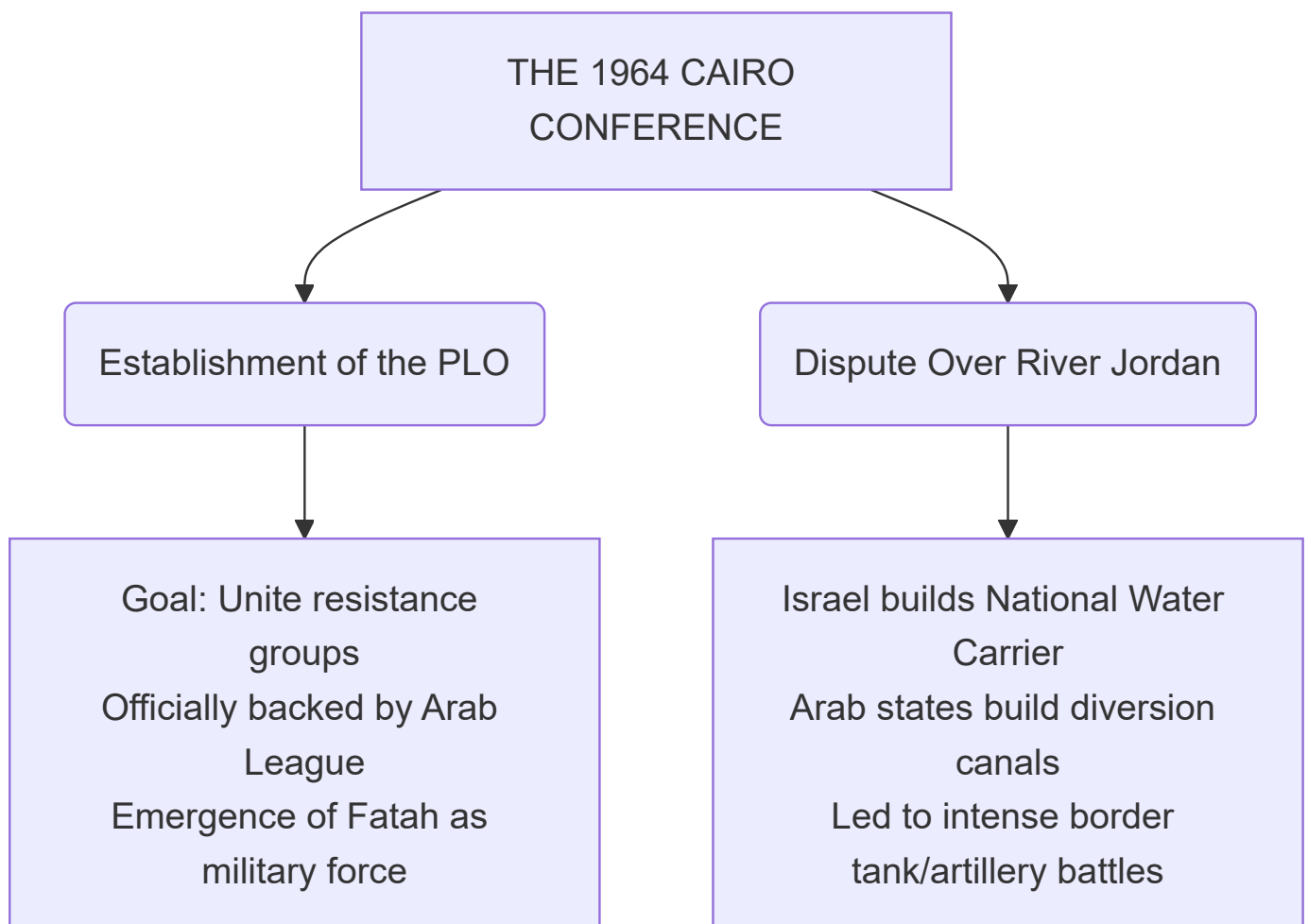
SPECIFICATION STUDY MAP: KEY TOPIC 2.1

1. **Palestinian Nationalism** → Cairo Conference (1964), creation of the PLO and Fatah.

2. **Border Wars & Skirmishes** → Disputes over Jordan water, Samu Raid (1966), 7 April 1967.
3. **The Slide to War (May '67)** → Soviet misinformation, UNEF withdrawal, closure of Tiran.
4. **The Six Day War** → June 5 pre-emptive strike, lightning land war, redrawn boundaries.

The decade of relative border peace secured by the UN Emergency Force (UNEF) buffer began to disintegrate in the mid-1960s as a new wave of radical Palestinian nationalism swept the region. In January 1964, President Nasser hosted the historic Cairo Conference of the Arab League. At this summit, Arab leaders took the monumental step of establishing the Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO). The primary objective of the PLO was to unite various Palestinian resistance groups under a single political umbrella to destroy the State of Israel and reclaim the lost homeland for the Palestinian refugees.

Q1. What was the primary objective of the Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) when it was established at the 1964 Cairo Conference?



Alongside this diplomatic development, a radical guerrilla movement called Fatah (founded in 1959 by Yasser Arafat) began to dominate Palestinian military activity. Unlike older Arab politicians who relied on conventional state-to-state warfare, Fatah believed that only a grassroots, irregular guerrilla war could liberate Palestine. At the Cairo Conference, tensions also flared over a vital shared resource: water. Israel had completed its massive National Water Carrier engineering project to divert fresh water from the Sea of Galilee south to irrigate the

Negev Desert. Viewing this as an act of aggression, Arab leaders at the conference agreed to divert the headwaters of the River Jordan (specifically the Dan and Banias rivers) inside Syria and Lebanon to starve Israel of water.

Q2. How did the dispute over the River Jordan escalate tensions between Israel and the Arab states in the mid-1960s?

By 1965, this dispute erupted into an active border war. Whenever Syrian workers began building diversion canals, Israeli tanks and artillery fired across the border to destroy their heavy machinery, driving Syria and Israel into a cycle of violent border clashes. By 1966, the border between Israel and its Arab neighbours had become a volatile combat zone. This escalation was fueled primarily by a radical, left-wing military coup in Syria in February 1966.

The new Syrian government adopted a fiercely aggressive posture toward Israel. They began actively sponsoring Fatah, providing Palestinian guerrilla fighters with funds, modern explosives, and training bases inside Syrian territory. From these bases, Fatah launched a relentless campaign of cross-border sabotage raids into Israel. Rather than attacking the Syrian military directly, Israel's retaliatory strikes focused on the countries from which Fatah fighters infiltrated, pushing relations to the breaking point:

Q3. How did the new Syrian government support the Fatah guerrilla movement from 1966 onwards?

Syria funds/arms Fatah
guerrillas



Fatah launches sabotage
raids into Israel



IDF launches massive
reprisal on Jordanian Samu



King Hussein is deeply alienated

The Samu Raid (November 1966): After a Fatah landmine killed three Israeli border policemen, Prime Minister Levi Eshkol ordered a massive reprisal raid into Jordan, which controlled the West Bank. On 13 November 1966, 600 IDF troops backed by tanks swept into the Jordanian village of Samu, dynamiting dozens of homes and clashing with the Jordanian military, leaving 15 Jordanian soldiers dead. The raid deeply embarrassed King Hussein of Jordan, who publicly accused President Nasser of hiding behind UN peacekeepers instead of helping defend his Arab allies. The Air Clash of 7 April 1967: Skirmishes on the Syrian border erupted into full-scale combat when Syrian artillery on the Golan Heights began bombarding Israeli tractors farming in the demilitarised zone. The Israeli air force responded aggressively. In a dramatic aerial dogfight over Damascus, Israeli fighter jets shot down six Syrian Soviet-built MiG-21 jets in a single afternoon. This humiliating defeat left the Syrian leadership desperate to find a way to restore their military honor.

Q4. What was the outcome of the April 1967 air clash over Damascus, and how did it affect the Syrian leadership?

THE MAY 1967 CASCADE: CHRONOLOGY OF CRISIS

13 May → *Soviet Misinformation*: USSR falsely tells Nasser Israel is massing troops on Syria.

15 May → *Egyptian Mobilization*: Nasser puts army on alert, moves troops into Sinai.

16 May → *UN Out*: Nasser orders UN peacekeepers (UNEF) to evacuate the border buffer.

23 May → *Maritime Blockade*: Egypt closes the Straits of Tiran, choking Israel's port of Eilat.

30 May → *Encirclement*: King Hussein of Jordan signs a joint defence pact with Egypt.

The humiliation of the April air clash set off a rapid chain reaction in May 1967 that made a major regional war virtually inevitable. The Catalyst: Soviet Misinformation (13 May). The Soviet Union intervened by issuing a formal, highly urgent warning to President Nasser, claiming that Israel was massing ten brigades on the Syrian border for a full-scale invasion. This report was completely false—UN observers on the ground confirmed there was no Israeli troop build-up—but it placed Nasser under immense pressure to act.

Q5. How did the Soviet Union's misinformation in May 1967 act as a catalyst for the crisis?

Nasser's Gamble: Accused of cowardice by Jordan and Syria, Nasser decided he had to demonstrate his leadership of the Arab world. On 15 May, he placed the Egyptian army on high alert and marched his troops across the Suez Canal into the Sinai Desert. On 16 May, he ordered the UNEF commander to immediately withdraw all UN peacekeepers from the Sinai border, leaving the Egyptian and Israeli armies standing face-to-

face. Closing the Straits of Tiran (23 May): In his most dangerous move, Nasser ordered Egyptian troops to reoccupy Sharm el-Sheikh and closed the Straits of Tiran to all Israeli shipping. Israel had repeatedly declared that closing the Straits would be considered a formal casus belli (an act of war), as it choked off its oil imports and trade through Eilat.

Q6. Identify two dangerous gambles President Nasser took between 15 May and 23 May 1967.

The Jordan-Egypt Defence Pact (30 May): To Israel's horror, King Hussein of Jordan flew to Cairo and signed a mutual defence treaty with Nasser, placing the Jordanian army under the command of an Egyptian general. Israel now faced a fully coordinated military encirclement on three fronts by armies openly calling for its destruction. Believing an Arab invasion was imminent, the newly formed Israeli National Unity Government—including war hero Moshe Dayan as Defense Minister—decided to launch a pre-emptive strike to secure its survival.

The Air War: Operation Focus (5 June 1967). On the morning of 5 June 1967, Israel launched Operation Focus, the most successful pre-emptive air strike in modern military history. At 7:45 AM, nearly the entire Israeli air force flew low over the Mediterranean Sea to evade Egyptian radar, catching the Egyptian air force completely by surprise as they ate breakfast. Within three hours, Israeli jets bombed the runways and destroyed 309 of Egypt's 340 combat aircraft while they were still parked on the tarmac.

Q7. Describe the success of Operation Focus launched by the Israeli air force on 5 June 1967.

Later that day, when Syria, Jordan, and Iraq entered the war, Israel turned its jets on their airfields, destroying their air forces as well. By the end of day one, Israel had secured absolute air superiority, guaranteeing its ground forces total protection and leaving Arab infantry completely exposed to aerial attack.

OPERATION FOCUS: 5
JUNE 1967

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graph TD; A[OPERATION FOCUS: 5  
JUNE 1967] --> B[Low-altitude surprise air  
strike]; B --> C[Egyptian radar successfully  
bypassed]; C --> D[ ];
```

Low-altitude surprise air
strike

Egyptian radar successfully
bypassed



Bomb runways & destroy
309 Egyptian jets



Total Israeli air superiority
secured

The Land War: The Lightning Conquests. With the skies secured, the IDF launched a highly coordinated, three-front blitzkrieg that redrew the map of the Middle East in just six days. The Southern Front (Egypt): Israeli tank divisions led by General Ariel Sharon raced across the Sinai Desert, routing the Egyptian forces and advancing all the way to the east bank of the Suez Canal, capturing the entire Sinai Peninsula and the Gaza Strip.

Q8. What were the key territorial conquests of the Israeli Defence Forces during the land war?

The Eastern Front (Jordan): After Jordan began shelling West Jerusalem, Israeli forces launched a fierce counter-offensive. They captured the entire West Bank and, in a deeply emotional victory, took control of the Old City of East Jerusalem, reuniting the city under Jewish control for the first time in 2,000 years. The Northern Front (Syria): On 9 June, Israeli forces turned north and scaled the steep cliffs of the Golan Heights under heavy Syrian fire, capturing the strategic plateau and putting the Syrian capital of Damascus within range of Israeli artillery.

By the time a United Nations ceasefire took effect on 10 June 1967, the war was over. Israel had achieved a miraculous victory, defeating three major Arab armies and expanding its territory to three times its pre-war size.

Captured Territory	Captured From	Strategic Value
Sinai Peninsula	Egypt	Vast desert buffer zone
Gaza Strip	Egypt	Eliminated Fedayeen bases

Captured Territory	Captured From	Strategic Value
West Bank	Jordan	Defensible borders (Jordan)
East Jerusalem	Jordan	Holy Sites (Western Wall)
Golan Heights	Syria	Protected Galilee farming

Q9. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the May 1967 crisis that led to the outbreak of the Six Day War. (8 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Was Israel justified in launching a pre-emptive strike against Egypt? Discuss both perspectives.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Six Day War (1967).
(8 marks)

Planning your narrative account:

Remember to link your paragraphs chronologically. You could use these sentence starters:

- *The first key event was...*
- *This directly led to...*
- *Consequently, this triggered...*
- *This situation culminated in...*

Lined area for writing the narrative account.

Exam Practice

1. Explain the importance of the Cairo Conference (1964) for the Arab states in the years 1964-73. (8 marks)

2. Explain one consequence of Syria's support for Fatah 1964-67. (4 marks)

3. Explain one consequence of the Israeli raid on Samu, 1966, for developments in the Middle East. (4 marks)

5. Explain one consequence of disputes over the River Jordan waters. (4 marks)

4. Write a narrative account analysing the rising tension in the Middle East in the years 1964-67 which led to the Six Day War. (8 marks)

6. Explain the importance of disputes over the River Jordan waters for border tension between Israel and Syria. (8 marks)

7. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Six Day War 1967. (8 marks)

Documentary / General Notes

Title / Topic: _____

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

KT2.2: The Aftermath of the 1967 War

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand UN Resolution 242 and the continued dispute over the Suez Canal.
- ☐ Analyze the situation of Palestinian refugees and the significance of the occupied territories: Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank, Sinai and East Jerusalem.
- ☐ Evaluate the use of terrorism, Israel's response and international attitudes towards the Palestine issue: the PFLP airplane hijacks of 1970; Black September and the Munich Olympics; and the expulsion of the PLO from Jordan (1970).

The Six Day War left Israel holding territories completely inhabited by Palestinians: the West Bank, Gaza Strip, and East Jerusalem. While Israelis celebrated the reunification of Jerusalem, the UN passed Resolution 242 demanding they withdraw. The ongoing occupation of these lands remains the core of the conflict today.

Did you know?

- Resolution 242: The famous UN resolution stating 'land for peace', demanding Israeli withdrawal from occupied territories.
- The PLO: Following the Arab defeat, the Palestinian Liberation Organisation emerged as an independent military force.
- East Jerusalem: Israel unilaterally annexed the eastern half of the holy city, a move not recognised internationally.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. What major political organization was established at the Cairo Conference in January 1964 with the backing of the Arab League, and what was its primary objective?

2.



Who is this leader, and what organisation did he take over in 1969?

3. Explain how disputes over water resources between Israel and Syria in the mid-1960s contributed to rising regional tensions.

4. What was the Samu Raid of November 1966, and how did it affect King Hussein of Jordan's position?

5. What major air battle occurred on 7 April 1967, and how did it affect Syrian military morale?

6. How did the Soviet Union act as a catalyst for the May 1967 crisis?

7. Detail three specific actions taken by Gamal Abdel Nasser in May 1967 that Israel considered a direct casus belli (act of war).

8. What was Operation Focus, launched on 5 June 1967, and why was it so critical to the outcome of the war?

9. List the territories captured by Israel during the Six Day War and identify the nation from which each was taken.

10. Write an analytical sentence linking the May 1967 Crisis to the ultimate outcome of the Six Day War.

Vocabulary Check

Style: Mini-Frayer Model

Complete the Frayer Model for the term: **UN Resolution 242**

Definition	Historical Example
Non-Example / Sketch	Your own sentence

The Khartoum Resolution



Egyptian President Gamal Abdel Nasser, who led the Arab rejectionist stance at the 1967 Khartoum Conference with the famous 'Three No's'.

UN Resolution 242

UN RESOLUTION 242

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graph TD; A[UN RESOLUTION 242] --> B[English Wording: Loophole]; A --> C[French Wording: Strict]; B --> D["Withdrawal from territories<br/>Israel argued it did NOT mean ALL territories; allowed border expansion"]; C --> E["'des territoires occupés'<br/>Interpreted as requiring a complete withdrawal to 1967 lines"];
```

English Wording: Loophole

French Wording: Strict

Withdrawal from territories
Israel argued it did NOT mean ALL territories; allowed border expansion

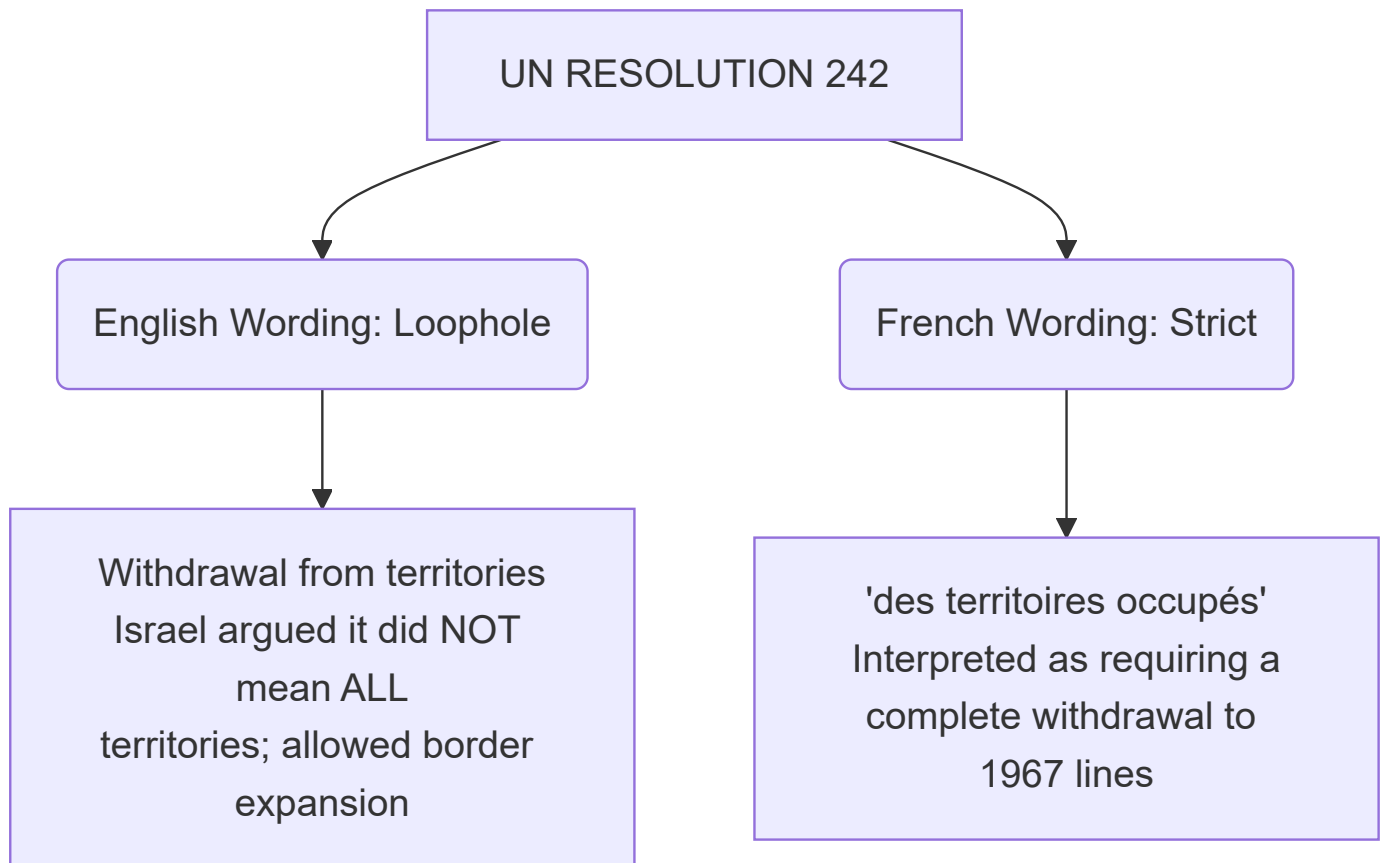
'des territoires occupés'
Interpreted as requiring a complete withdrawal to 1967 lines

UN Resolution 242, which established the 'Land for Peace' formula for resolving the Arab-Israeli conflict.

Yasser Arafat and the PLO



The lightning ending of the Six Day War left the Middle East in a deep diplomatic deadlock. On 22 November 1967, the United Nations Security Council unanimously adopted Resolution 242. This resolution was designed to establish the guiding principles for a "just and lasting peace" in the region, introducing the fundamental "land for peace" formula. Resolution 242 stressed the "inadmissibility of the acquisition of territory by war" and called for: 1. The withdrawal of Israeli armed forces from territories occupied in the conflict. 2. The termination of all states of belligerency, and respect for the right of every state in the area to live in peace within secure and recognized borders. 3. A just settlement of the refugee problem.



However, the resolution's deliberate ambiguity created long-term loopholes that both sides exploited. The English text called for withdrawal from "territories occupied," omitting the definite article 'the'. Israel's government argued this meant they were not required to withdraw from all the occupied land, but rather from some territories, to ensure "secure and recognized" borders. Conversely, the equally official French version translated the phrase as "des territoires occupés" (from the territories), which the Arab states interpreted as a mandate for a complete Israeli return to the pre-war boundaries. The PLO immediately rejected Resolution 242 because it referred to the Palestinians merely as a "refugee problem" rather than as a nation with a legitimate right to self-determination and statehood.

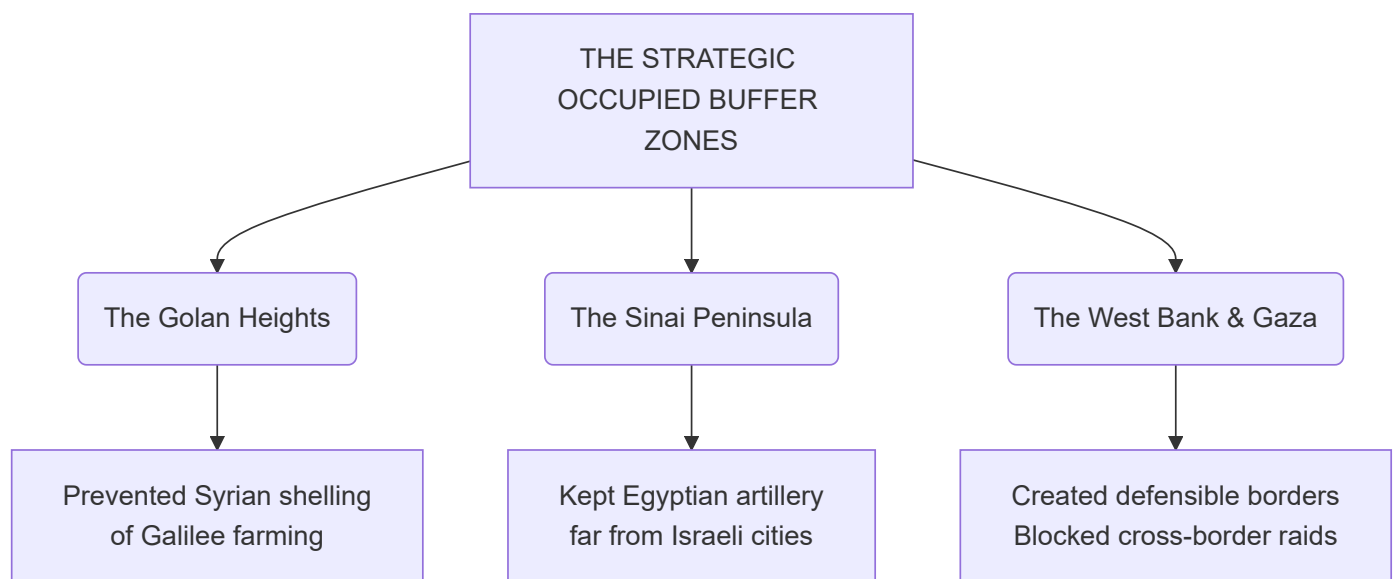
Q1. How did Israel and the Arab states interpret the ambiguous wording of UN Resolution 242 differently?

The Arab states responded defiantly at the Arab League Summit in Khartoum in August 1967. They issued the famous "Three Nos" of Khartoum: No peace with Israel, No recognition of Israel, and No negotiations with Israel. This diplomatic deadlock meant the Suez Canal—which Egypt had blocked at the start of the war—remained closed. The canal became a heavily fortified military front line separating the Egyptian army on the

west bank from the IDF on the east bank, leading directly to the War of Attrition (1969–1970). The Six Day War triggered a second massive wave of Palestinian displacement. Approximately 300,000 Palestinian Arabs fled the West Bank and Gaza Strip during the fighting, with many being forced to flee for a second time from existing refugee camps.

Q2. What was the defiant response of the Arab states at the August 1967 Arab League Summit in Khartoum?

The vast majority crossed the River Jordan, putting immense economic strain on Jordan. This left over 1.5 million Palestinians living under military occupation or in crowded, temporary UNRWA camps.



For Israel's security, the captured territories held immense strategic and military significance. The territories acted as vast physical buffers. The Sinai Desert kept Egyptian artillery far from Israel's borders, the West Bank created a defensible border along the River Jordan, and the Golan Heights prevented Syria from shelling Israeli farming villages in Galilee. The Golan Heights also provided vital water sources, while the Sinai Peninsula offered oil fields in the Gulf of Suez. Israel immediately annexed East Jerusalem, declaring the unified city its eternal capital.

Q3. Explain the strategic significance of the captured territories for Israel's military security.

However, the occupation quickly became a source of deep political and demographic division. In September 1967, Israel established its first Jewish settlement in Gush Etzion on the West Bank. Under both Labor and Likud governments, Israel promoted a policy of building Jewish settlements in the occupied territories, offering financial subsidies and tax breaks to settlers. By the late 1980s, the number of settlers rose to over 200,000, creating permanent "facts on the ground" that fragmented Palestinian society, restricted movement through military checkpoints, and deeply alienated the local Arab population. The total military defeat of conventional Arab armies in 1967 convinced Palestinian nationalists that they could not rely on Arab states to liberate their homeland. Under Yasser Arafat's leadership, the PLO shifted toward guerrilla warfare and irregular tactics.

Q4. How did the Israeli policy of building Jewish settlements in the occupied territories impact the local Arab population?

Simultaneously, more radical, Marxist splinter groups emerged, most notably the Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine (PFLP), founded by George Habash.

Conventional Arab Armies
Defeated 1967



Grassroots Nationalist
Awakening



Radical Splinter Groups
Form e.g. PFLP



Strategy of Internationalized Terror



Dawson's Field Hijackings
1970



World Spotlight Forced
onto Palestinian Issue

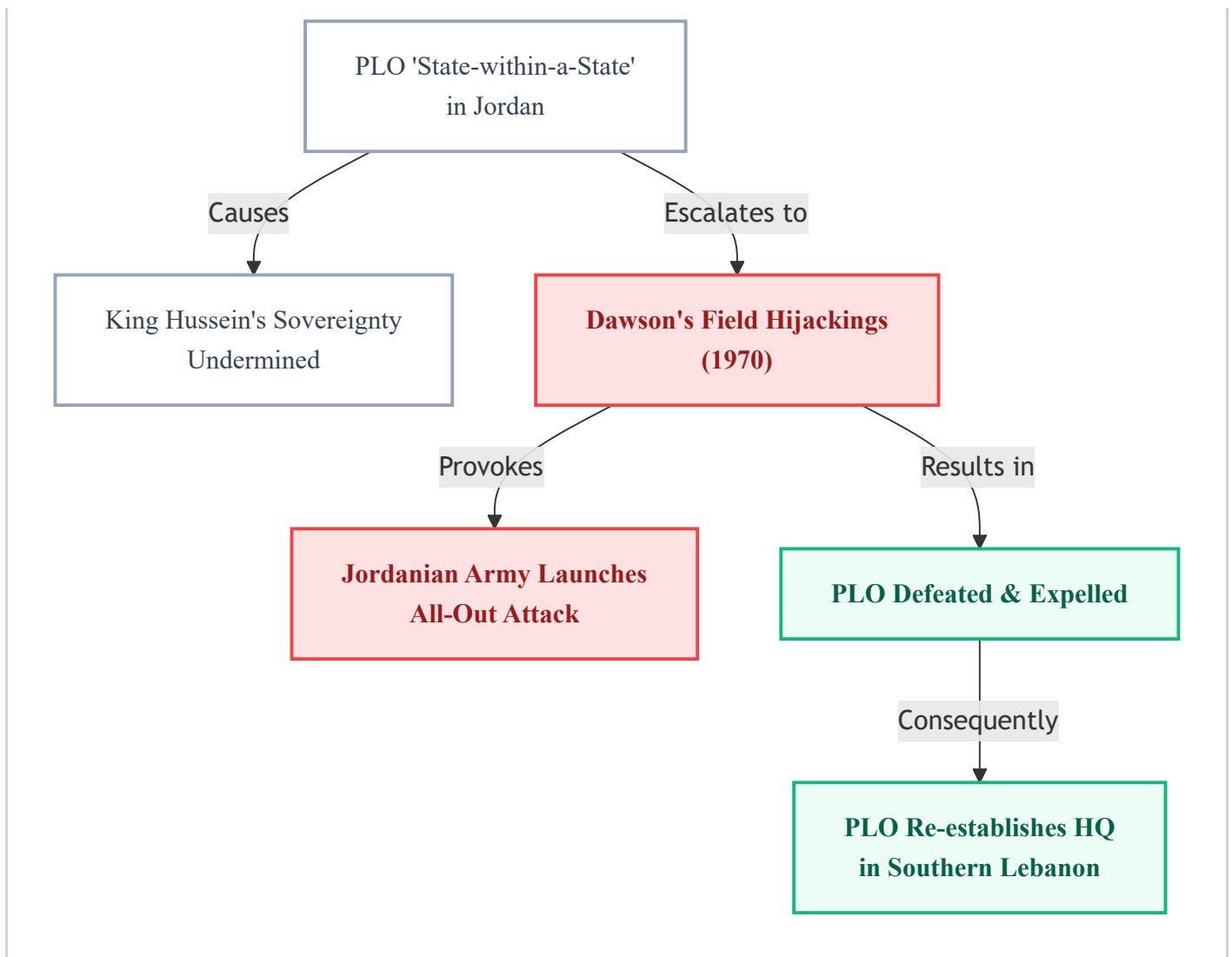
To force the Palestinian issue onto the international diplomatic stage, the PFLP pioneered international aviation terrorism. On 6 September 1970, PFLP militants hijacked four international commercial airliners bound for New York and forced three of them to land at Dawson's Field, a remote desert airstrip near Zarka in Jordan. After evacuating the passengers, the hijackers blew up the multi-million-dollar aircraft in front of the world's media. This dramatic event succeeded in grabbing global attention, but it also deeply embarrassed Jordan's King Hussein, whose sovereignty had been publicly undermined.

Q5. Why did the Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine (PFLP) hijack commercial airliners to Dawson's Field in 1970?

By 1970, the PLO had established a virtual "state-within-a-state" inside Jordan, collecting its own taxes, running checkpoints, and launching unauthorized rocket attacks on Israel, which drew destructive Israeli military reprisals onto Jordanian territory. The Dawson's Field hijackings were the final straw for King Hussein. He realized that the PLO threatened to overthrow his Hashemite monarchy and plunge Jordan into a civil war.

Q6. Why did King Hussein of Jordan view the PLO as a threat to his sovereignty by 1970?

THE BLACK SEPTEMBER CIVIL WAR



On 17 September 1970, King Hussein declared martial law and ordered his elite, British-trained army to launch an all-out military offensive against PLO bases in Amman and northern Jordan. This brutal, ten-day civil war became known as "Black September". The Jordanian army used heavy artillery and tanks in crowded refugee camps, crushing the PLO forces.

Q7. What was the outcome of the 'Black September' civil war in Jordan in 1970?

Defeated and politically isolated, Yasser Arafat and thousands of PLO fighters were forcibly expelled from Jordan. They relocated their central headquarters to Lebanon, establishing a new base of operations in southern Lebanon (known as "Fatahland") and Beirut, which destabilized Lebanon's delicate political balance. In the wake of their defeat in Jordan, a radical, highly secretive PLO splinter group calling itself "Black September" was formed to conduct covert operations against Israeli and Western targets. Their most notorious attack occurred during the Munich Olympic Games in September 1972.

On 5 September 1972, eight heavily armed Black September terrorists scaled the fence of the Olympic Village in Munich, killing two members of the Israeli Olympic team and taking nine others hostage. The terrorists demanded the release of 234 Palestinian prisoners held in Israeli jails. During a botched rescue attempt by West German police at the Fürstenfeldbruck military airfield, the terrorists detonated a grenade inside a helicopter containing the bound hostages. In total, 11 Israeli athletes, five terrorists, and one German police

officer were killed. The massacre unfolded on live television, shocking a global audience of hundreds of millions. It drew severe international condemnation of Palestinian terrorism, but it also succeeded in giving the Palestinian cause unprecedented public visibility.

Q8. Describe the events and consequences of the 1972 Munich Olympic Games terrorist attack.

In response, Israeli Prime Minister Golda Meir ordered the IDF to launch heavy bombing raids against PLO camps in Lebanon and Syria. More significantly, she authorized the Mossad to launch "Operation Wrath of God"—a highly secretive, global assassination campaign that hunted down and killed the key planners of the Munich massacre across Europe and the Middle East.

Q9. Write a narrative account analysing the key developments in the Palestinian issue in the years 1970–72. (8 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Why did the spectacular Israeli victory in 1967 actually make a long-term peace agreement more difficult?

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

GCSE Exam Practice

Explain one consequence of the Six Day War (1967). (4 marks)

Exam Practice

1. Explain one consequence of the 1967 Six Day War. (4 marks)

2. Explain the importance of the occupied territories for Israelis and Palestinians after 1967. (8 marks)

6. Explain one consequence of the expulsion of the PLO from Jordan in 1970. (4 marks)

7. Explain one consequence of the PFLP airplane hijacks of 1970. (4 marks)

3. Explain the importance of Israel's consolidation of control of the occupied territories for relations between Israel and the Palestinians in the years 1967–73. (8 marks)

4. Explain the importance of the occupied territories for relations between Israel and the Arab world after the Six Day War, 1967. (8 marks)

5. Explain the importance of the use of Terrorism by Palestinians in the 1970's for the Palestinian issue. (8 marks)

8. Explain the importance of the expulsion of the PLO from Jordan, 1970, for PLO activities in Lebanon. (8 marks)

Documentary / General Notes

Title / Topic: _____

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

KT2.3: Israel and Egypt, 1967–1973

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Analyze Egyptian relations with Israel, the USA, the USSR and other Arab states.
- ☐ Understand Israel's consolidation of control of the occupied territories.
- ☐ Describe the key events of the Yom Kippur War (1973) and its aftermath.

Determined to avenge the humiliation of 1967 and regain the Sinai Peninsula, Egypt's Anwar Sadat launched a surprise attack on Israel during Yom Kippur, the holiest day in the Jewish calendar. The initial Arab success shattered Israel's feeling of invincibility and forced them back to the negotiating table.

Did you know?

- Yom Kippur: October 6, 1973, when Egyptian and Syrian forces launched their coordinated surprise attack.
- The Bar Lev Line: The supposedly impenetrable Israeli sand defenses along the Suez Canal, which Egypt breached in hours using water cannons.
- Oil Embargo: Arab oil-producing states stopped selling oil to countries supporting Israel, causing a global economic crisis.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. What major United Nations Security Council Resolution was passed on 22 November 1967 to establish the guiding principles of a 'land for peace' formula?

2. Name the radical, Marxist-leaning Palestinian group founded by George Habash that pioneered international aviation terrorism in the early 1970s.

3. Explain how a translation discrepancy in the wording of UN Resolution 242 created a loophole that hindered its implementation.

4. What Arabic term refers to the Arab League Summit of August 1967, and what were the famous declarations issued there?

5. What was the immediate result of the Dawson's Field hijackings of September 1970 for the PLO's position in Jordan?

6. To which country did the PLO relocate its central headquarters after its expulsion from Jordan in 1970–71?

7. Describe the events of the Munich Olympics of September 1972 and state how Israel's Prime Minister Golda Meir responded.

8. How did Israel's capture of the Golan Heights, the West Bank, the Gaza Strip, and the Sinai Peninsula in 1967 initially improve its military security?

9. Why did the PLO reject UN Resolution 242?

10. Write an analytical sentence linking the outcome of the Six Day War to the rise of international Palestinian terrorism.

Vocabulary Check

Style: Contextual Cloze

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

War of Attrition | SAM-3 Missiles | Bar Lev Line | Operation Nickel Grass | OPEC Oil Weapon

Following the devastating 1967 defeat, Egypt engaged in a continuous _____ against Israel, regularly shelling the heavily fortified _____ along the Suez Canal. When the Yom Kippur War broke out in 1973, Israel suffered heavy early losses until the US launched _____, a massive airlift to supply them with crucial weapons and _____ replacements. In retaliation for Western support of Israel, Arab nations deployed the _____, embargoing oil exports and triggering a severe global economic crisis.

The Yom Kippur War (1973)



Egyptian forces successfully crossing the Suez Canal during the surprise attack on Yom Kippur in 1973.

Israeli Counter-Offensive



General Ariel Sharon leading the Israeli counter-offensive across the Sinai desert towards Egypt in the later stages of the Yom Kippur War.

Golda Meir



Israeli Prime Minister Golda Meir, whose government faced severe criticism for lack of preparedness in 1973.

The immediate aftermath of the 1967 war did not bring peace, but rather a grueling, undeclared border war along the Suez Canal known as the War of Attrition (1969–1970). Egyptian President Gamal Abdel Nasser refused to accept the static Israeli occupation of the Sinai Peninsula. Backed by massive military aid from the

Soviet Union, Nasser launched a continuous campaign of heavy artillery shelling, commando raids, and rocket barrages across the Suez Canal to wear down the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) and make the occupation too costly to sustain.

THE COLD WAR ESCALATION ON THE SUEZ



Nasser launches artillery
bombardments



Israel retaliates with deep
air strikes



```
graph TD; A[Egypt receives 15,000 Soviet advisors] --> B[Soviet SAM-3 missile sites built 1970]; B --> C[US mediates August 1970 Ceasefire]; C --> D[ ];
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Egypt receives 15,000
Soviet advisors

Soviet SAM-3 missile sites
built 1970

US mediates August 1970
Ceasefire

...

Uneasy stalemate remains unaddressed

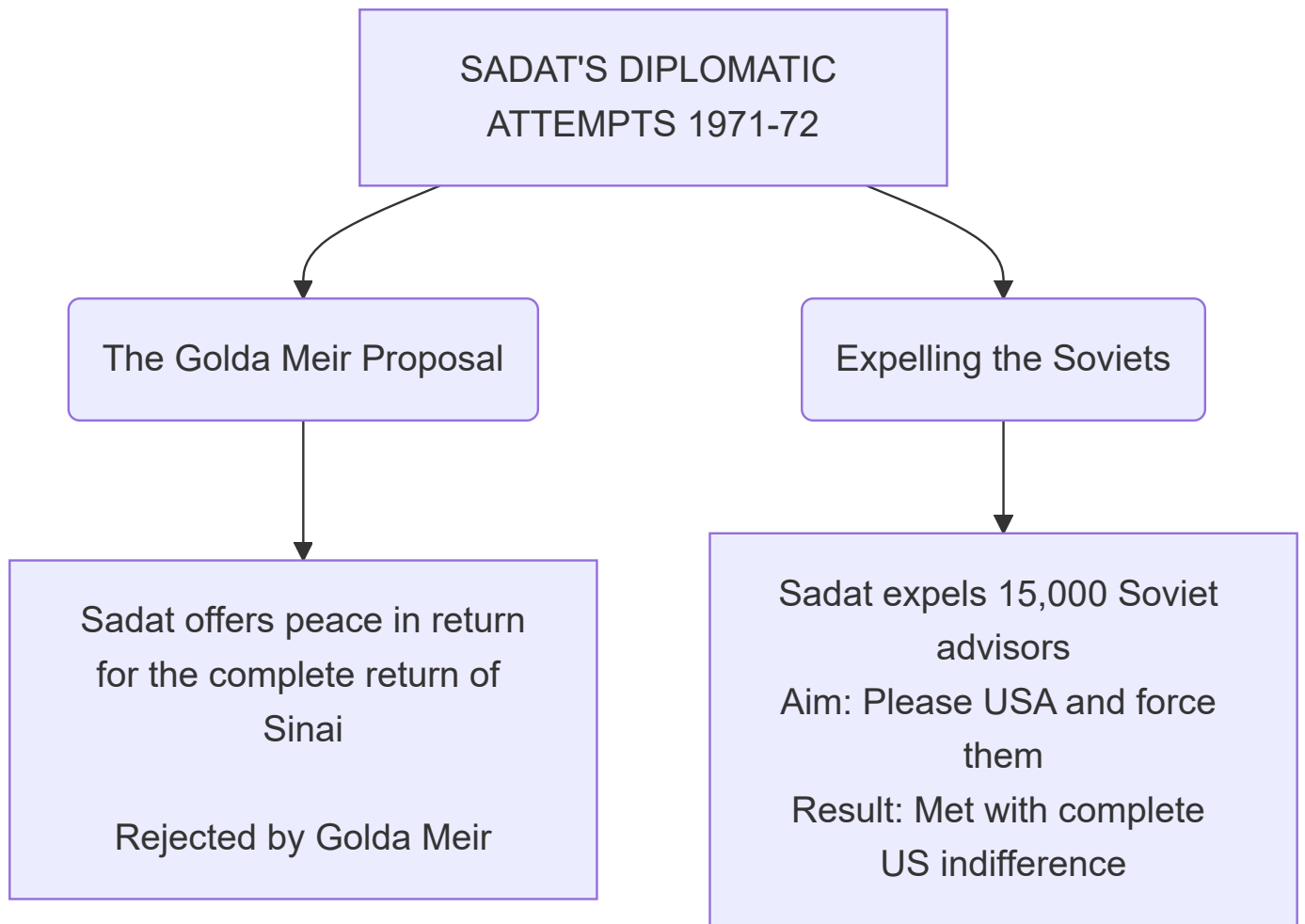
Israel responded aggressively by utilizing its absolute air superiority to conduct deep-penetration bombing raids into Egypt, targeting Egyptian military garrisons, industrial factories, and infrastructure along the Nile. To protect his regime, Nasser turned directly to his Soviet patrons. By 1970, approximately 15,000 Soviet military advisers were stationed in Egypt. Soviet pilots actively flew combat missions, engaging Israeli jets in dogfights over the canal, while Soviet engineers constructed advanced SAM-3 surface-to-air missile bases along the Suez front.

Q1. How did Israel respond to Nasser's artillery bombardments during the War of Attrition, and what was Nasser's reaction?

Alarmed that this direct superpower clash could drag the United States and the USSR into a global conflict, US Secretary of State William Rogers intervened. In August 1970, he successfully brokered a ceasefire that halted the active fighting. However, neither Egypt nor Israel was committed to substantive peace talks. Shortly after, on 28 September 1970, the strain of regional politics took its toll when Nasser suffered a sudden, fatal heart attack. His death shocked the Arab world. Five million mourners flooded the streets of Cairo for his funeral, marking the end of the charismatic era of Pan-Arabism.

Nasser was succeeded by his relatively unknown and underestimated Vice President, Anwar Sadat. Sadat inherited a country on the brink of political and economic collapse. Egypt's economy was severely damaged by the continuous military mobilization, the Suez Canal was closed (depriving Egypt of vital transit toll revenues), and millions of displaced civilians had fled the devastated cities along the canal zone. Sadat realized that to rebuild Egypt's economy and send home his one million mobilized soldiers, he desperately needed to secure the return of the Sinai Peninsula and reopen the Suez Canal.

Q2. Why did Anwar Sadat believe he desperately needed to secure the return of the Sinai Peninsula?



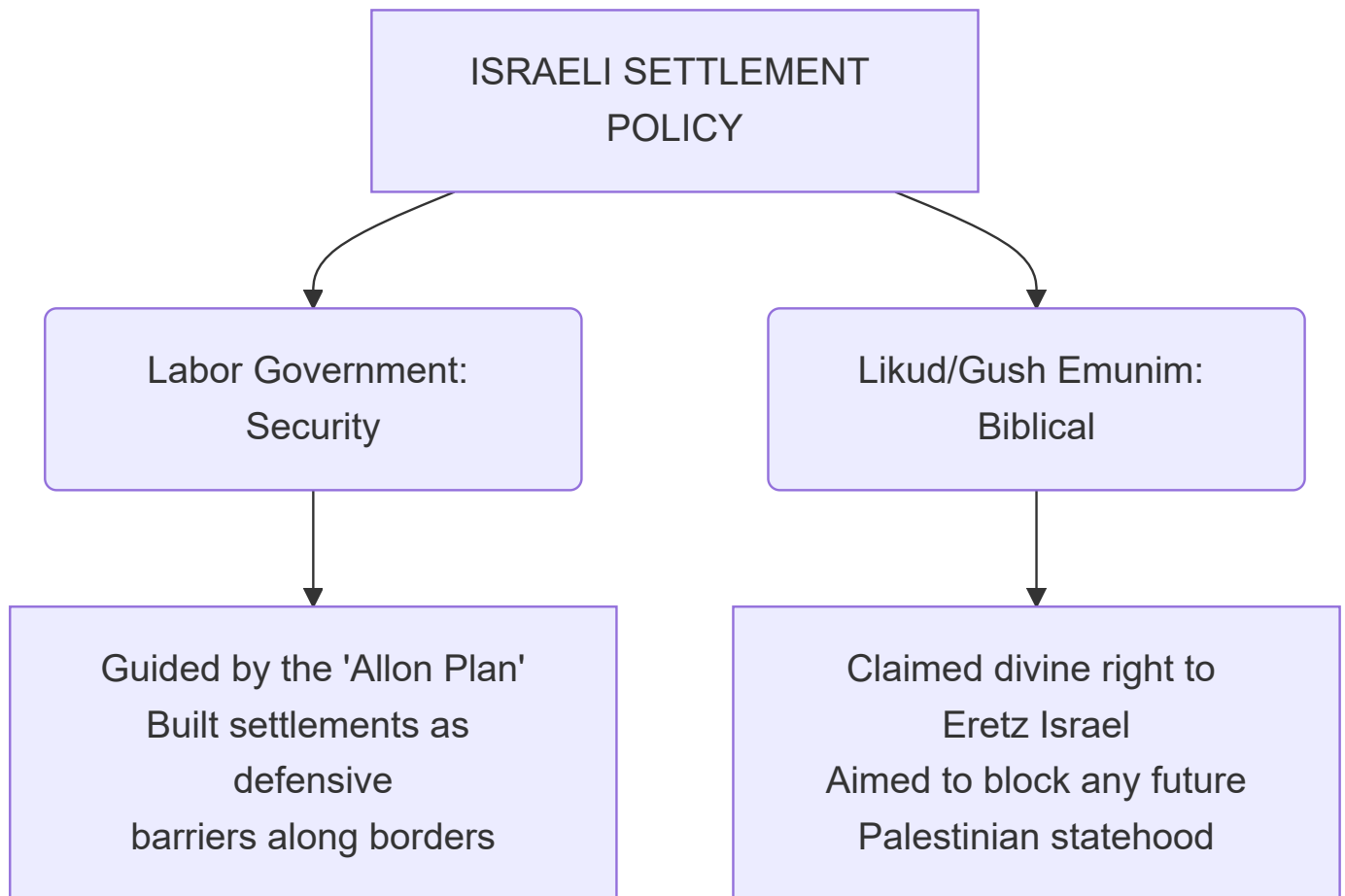
Between 1970 and 1972, Sadat pursued two distinct diplomatic tracks: The "Peace for Sinai" Offer and Expelling the Soviet Advisers. Sadat approached Israeli Prime Minister Golda Meir with a bold proposal based on UN Resolution 242. He offered a formal peace agreement and the reopening of the Suez Canal in exchange for Israel returning the Sinai Peninsula. Confident in their military superiority, Golda Meir and her cabinet rejected the offer, refusing to return to the vulnerable pre-1967 borders.

Q3. What was the 'Peace for Sinai' offer proposed by Anwar Sadat, and why did Golda Meir reject it?

Frustrated by Soviet reluctance to supply him with offensive weapons and hoping to win diplomatic favor with the United States, Sadat took the dramatic step of expelling 15,000 Soviet advisers from Egypt in July 1972. He calculated that this anti-communist move would prompt the US to pressure Israel into territorial concessions. However, the Nixon administration was preoccupied with the Vietnam War and met Sadat's gesture with total indifference. By late 1972, Sadat's popularity had plummeted to its lowest point. The Egyptian public mocked him, the economy was stagnant, and the Sinai remained firmly in Israeli hands. Sadat realized that Israel would never negotiate as long as it felt militarily secure. He concluded that Egypt's only option was to launch a limited, surprise military strike to shatter the myth of Israeli invincibility and force the global superpowers to intervene and broker a diplomatic solution.

Q4. Why did Sadat expel 15,000 Soviet advisers from Egypt in July 1972, and what was the US reaction?

While Egypt struggled with stagnation, Israel utilized the years between 1967 and 1973 to consolidate its firm military and political control over the Occupied Territories (the Sinai, Gaza, West Bank, Golan Heights, and East Jerusalem). Israel's policy transitioned from a temporary military occupation to a permanent program of state-sponsored colonization.

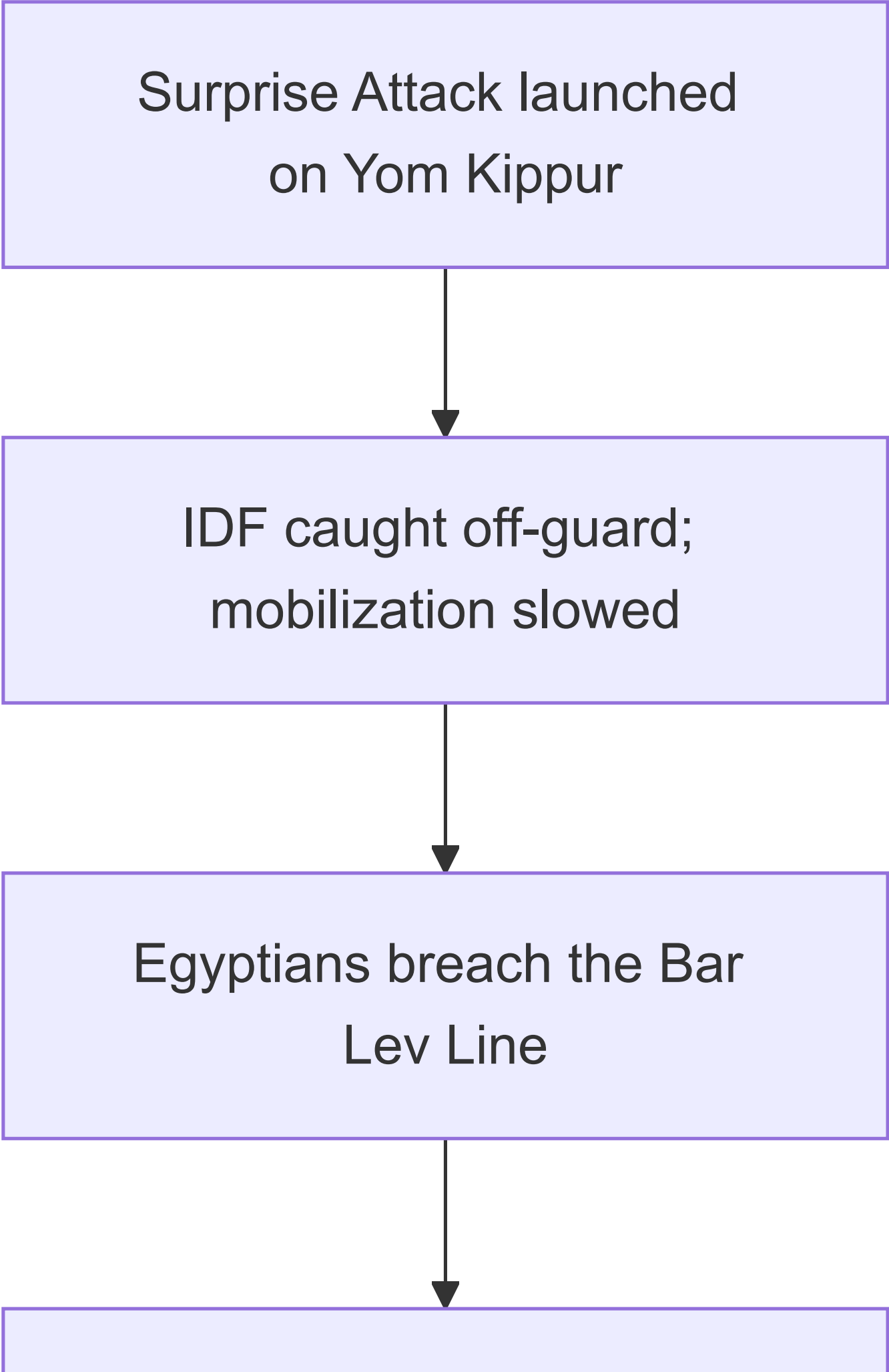


Along the east bank of the Suez Canal, Israel constructed a massive military fortification. The Bar Lev Line consisted of a towering, 20-meter-high artificial sand wall backed by concrete bunkers, artillery emplacements, and early-warning systems designed to make any Egyptian crossing of the canal impossible. Israel began constructing permanent civilian communities (settlements) in the captured lands. The ruling Labor coalition focused on establishing defensive settlements in strategic buffer zones, such as the Jordan Valley. However, religious-nationalist groups like Gush Emunim began establishing unauthorized, radical settlements deep in the biblical lands of the West Bank.

Q5. What was the Bar Lev Line, and what was its purpose?

By 1973, these settlements had become permanent "facts on the ground," deeply fragmenting Palestinian society and convincing Arab leaders that Israel was expanding permanently. On 6 October 1973, Sadat's secret plan for war was put into action. Egypt and its ally, Syria, launched a highly coordinated, two-front surprise attack against Israel.

Surprise Attack launched
on Yom Kippur



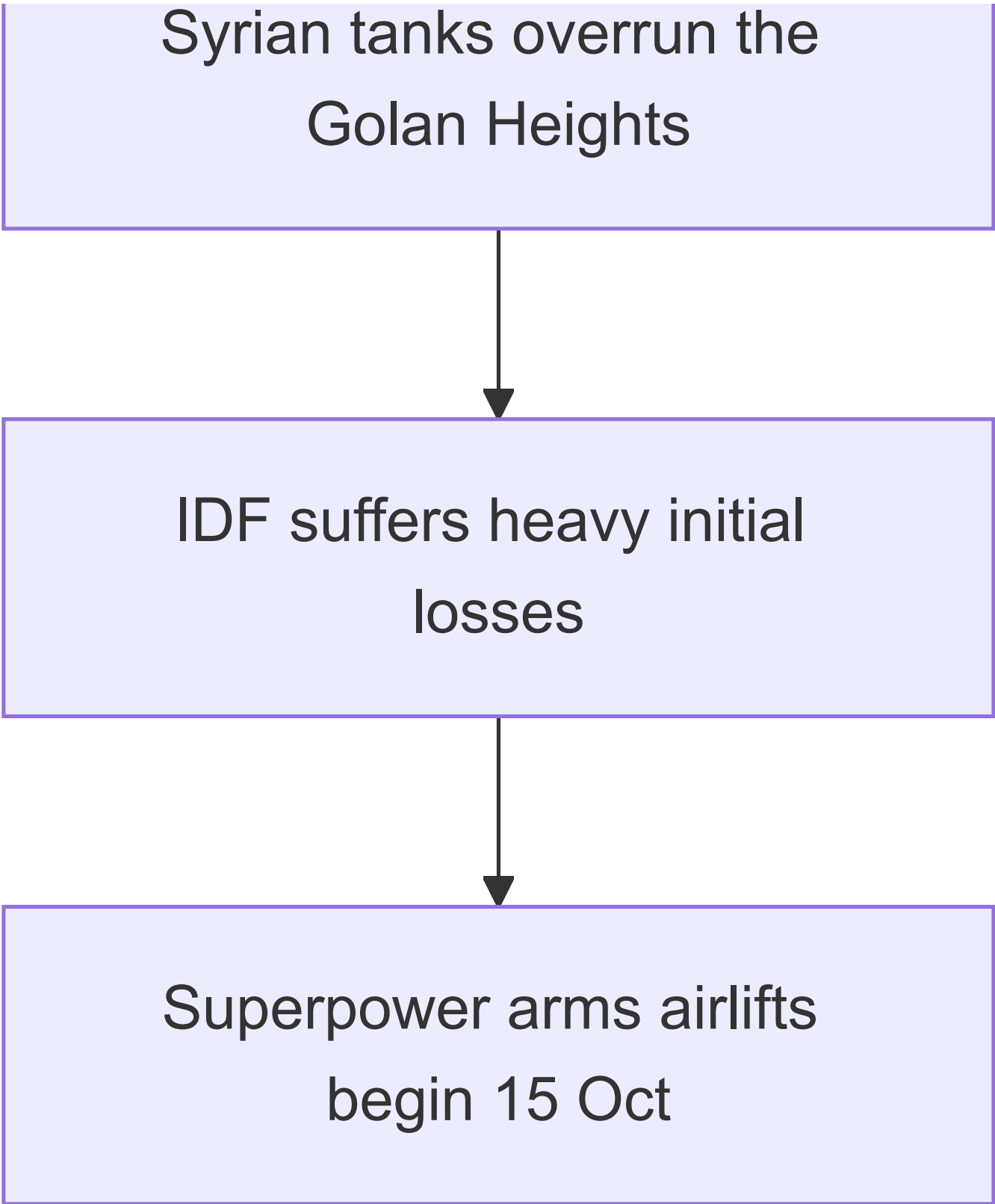
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graph TD; A[Surprise Attack launched on Yom Kippur] --> B[IDF caught off-guard; mobilization slowed]; B --> C[Egyptians breach the Bar Lev Line]; C --> D[ ];
```

IDF caught off-guard;
mobilization slowed

Egyptians breach the Bar
Lev Line



Syrian tanks overrun the
Golan Heights



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graph TD; A[Syrian tanks overrun the Golan Heights] --> B[IDF suffers heavy initial losses]; B --> C[Superpower arms airlifts begin 15 Oct]
```

IDF suffers heavy initial
losses

Superpower arms airlifts
begin 15 Oct

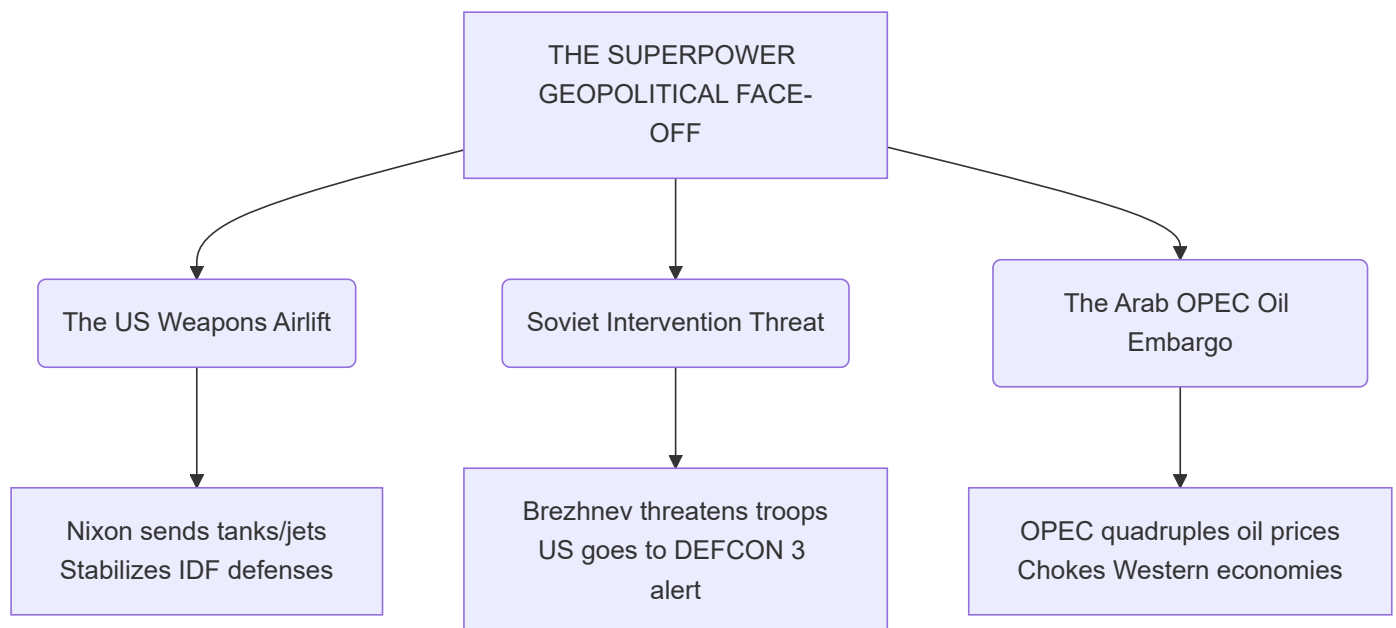
The offensive was launched on Yom Kippur, the holiest day in the Jewish calendar. On this day, Israel was at a complete standstill: radio stations were silent, shops were closed, public transport was shut down, and most soldiers were at home fasting. This severely delayed the mobilization of the IDF's reserve forces. Egyptian forces crossed the Suez Canal and used high-pressure water hoses pumped from the canal to rapidly wash away and breach Israel's formidable sand-wall defenses at the Bar Lev Line. Within hours, thousands of Egyptian infantry and tanks poured into Sinai, utilizing advanced Soviet-supplied anti-tank (Sagger) and anti-aircraft (SAM) missiles to destroy Israeli counter-attacks.

Q6. How did the Egyptian army successfully breach the Bar Lev Line at the start of the Yom Kippur War?

Simultaneously, Syrian tank divisions launched a massive assault across the Golan Heights, overrunning Israel's thin border defenses and threatening to break through into the Galilee. Caught completely off-guard, Israel suffered catastrophic initial casualties. For the first three days, the survival of the state hung in the balance. By 10 October 1973, Israeli reserves were fully mobilized, and the tide of the war began to turn through ruthless military execution and vital international assistance. On the Northern Front, the IDF successfully halted the Syrian advance and pushed Syrian forces back beyond the 1967 border.

On the Southern Front, the conflict escalated into a massive superpower proxy war. To replace Israel's heavy losses, US President Richard Nixon authorized Operation Nickel Grass on 12 October—a massive, direct military airlift of advanced American weapons, tanks, and ammunition that arrived in Israel on 15 October. Simultaneously, the Soviet Union launched an equally massive arms resupply to Egypt and Syria. Utilizing their newly arrived equipment, Israeli tank divisions led by General Ariel Sharon exploited a gap between Egypt's Second and Third Armies. The IDF crossed the Suez Canal onto the Egyptian mainland, destroying Soviet-bloc SAM missile sites and completely encircling Egypt's Third Army in the Sinai Desert.

Q7. Describe the superpower proxy conflict that emerged during the Yom Kippur War.



As the Egyptian Third Army faced complete destruction, the Soviet Union threatened to intervene directly by deploying Soviet troops to Egypt. To deter the Soviets, the United States put its military forces on a high-alert status (DEFCON 3), bringing the world to the brink of a nuclear confrontation. To resolve the crisis, the UN Security Council passed Resolution 338 on 22 October, calling for an immediate ceasefire. To force the United States to restrain Israel, the Arab members of OPEC unleashed the "Oil Weapon." They placed a total oil embargo on the US and Western nations that supported Israel, cutting production and quadrupling oil prices from \$3 to \$12 a barrel.

Q8. How did the Arab members of OPEC attempt to force the United States to restrain Israel?

Choked by a severe global energy crisis and fuel shortages, President Nixon pressured Israel into accepting a permanent ceasefire on 25 October 1973.

THE SIGNIFICANCE OF THE YOM KIPPUR WAR

For Egypt	For Israel	For the Peace Road
Sadat restored Egyptian honor and proved the Bar Lev Line was not invincible.	Golda Meir and Moshe Dayan resigned due to immense public anger over initial war failures.	Proved military force had limits; forced US into exhaustive "shuttle diplomacy".

Q9. Write a narrative account analysing the key developments of the Yom Kippur War (1973) and its aftermath. (8 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: How did the Yom Kippur War change the psychological balance of power between Israel and the Arab states?

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Yom Kippur War (1973). (8 marks)

Planning your narrative account:

Remember to link your paragraphs chronologically. You could use these sentence starters:

- *The first key event was...*
- *This directly led to...*
- *Consequently, this triggered...*
- *This situation culminated in...*

Handwriting practice lines for the narrative account.

Exam Practice

1. Explain the importance of superpower (USA/USSR) involvement in the conflict in the Middle East 1967-73. (8 marks)

2. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of Egypt's relationship with Israel 1968-73. (8 marks)

3. Explain one consequence of the ongoing dispute over the Suez Canal 1967-73. (4 marks)

6. Explain one consequence of the 1973 Yom Kippur War. (4 marks)

4. Write a narrative account analysing relations between Egypt and other states in the years 1967-73. (8 marks)

5. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the 1973 Yom Kippur War. (8 marks)

Documentary / General Notes

Title / Topic: _____

- Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8)

Teacher Comment:

KT3.1: Diplomatic negotiations, 1974–1979

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the significance of the oil crisis and the involvement of the USA and the USSR.
- ☐ Analyze Kissinger, 'shuttle diplomacy' and the reopening of the Suez Canal.
- ☐ Evaluate Sadat's visit to Israel (1977), Begin's visit to Egypt (1977), US President Carter and Camp David (1978) and the Treaty of Washington (1979).

In an unprecedented move that stunned the world, Egyptian President Anwar Sadat traveled to Jerusalem in 1977, offering peace. This bold step shattered the Arab taboo of refusing to talk to Israel and paved the way for the historic Camp David Accords, fundamentally altering the Middle East peace process.

Did you know?

- Camp David Accords (1978): Brokered by US President Jimmy Carter, leading to the first peace treaty between Israel and an Arab nation.
- Sinai Return: Israel agreed to return the entire Sinai Peninsula to Egypt in exchange for full diplomatic recognition.
- Assassination: Sadat was viewed as a traitor by many Arabs and was assassinated by Islamic extremists in 1981.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. Who succeeded Gamal Abdel Nasser as President of Egypt following his death in September 1970?

2. On which major Jewish holy day did Egypt and Syria launch their coordinated surprise attack in October 1973?

3. What was the name of the massive sand-wall fortification built by Israel along the east bank of the Suez Canal that Egyptian forces successfully overran?

4. Which global organisation, dominated by Arab oil-producing countries, implemented the 'oil weapon' in October 1973 to pressure Western nations?

5. What was the static, attrition-based conflict along the Suez Canal from 1969 to 1970 called, and which superpower provided Egypt with 15,000 advisors and SAM-3 missiles during it?

6. Why did Anwar Sadat make the dramatic decision to expel 15,000 Soviet military advisors from Egypt in July 1972?

7. Explain how the US military airlift, known as Operation Nickel Grass, influenced the course of the Yom Kippur War.

8. What were the two primary targets of Egypt's maritime blockade established in the years immediately following the 1949 armistice?

9. Explain the two key economic effects of the OPEC 'oil weapon' on Western nations supporting Israel in late 1973.

10. Write an analytical sentence linking the outcome of the Yom Kippur War to the emergence of diplomatic negotiations in the mid-1970s.

Vocabulary Check

Style: Vocabulary Mapping

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

OPEC | Shuttle Diplomacy | Likud | Camp David Accords | Treaty of Washington

Your Sentence:

Sadat visits Jerusalem



Egyptian President Anwar Sadat, who made a historic and unprecedented visit to Israel in 1977 to pursue peace.

The Camp David Accords (1978)



Begin, Carter, and Sadat shaking hands after successfully negotiating the Camp David Accords.

The Egypt-Israel Peace Treaty (1979)



Israeli Prime Minister Menachem Begin, who signed the historic Egypt-Israel Peace Treaty in 1979.

The Yom Kippur War of October 1973 was a military conflict that triggered a global economic and geopolitical revolution. Alarmed by the massive US arms airlift to Israel (Operation Nickel Grass), the Arab members of OPEC (Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries) enacted the "Oil Weapon." They placed a total oil embargo on the United States, Denmark, and the Netherlands, while cutting production for other Western nations by 25%. This move had a devastating, cascading impact on the global economy. The price of crude oil quadrupled in a matter of months, skyrocketing from \$3 to \$12 a barrel. Western industrial nations, highly dependent on cheap oil, plunged into a deep economic crisis characterized by soaring inflation (rising prices) and high unemployment. As oil prices rose, production costs increased, making goods more expensive; consequently, consumers bought fewer items, leading to factory bankruptcies and mass layoffs.

THE COGNITIVE IMPACT OF OPEC'S EMBARGO

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graph TD; A[THE COGNITIVE IMPACT OF OPEC'S EMBARGO] --> B[United States Peace Incentive]; B --> C[Economy severely damaged by inflation and fuel shortages  
Realized they must stabilize the Middle East to prevent future oil crises];
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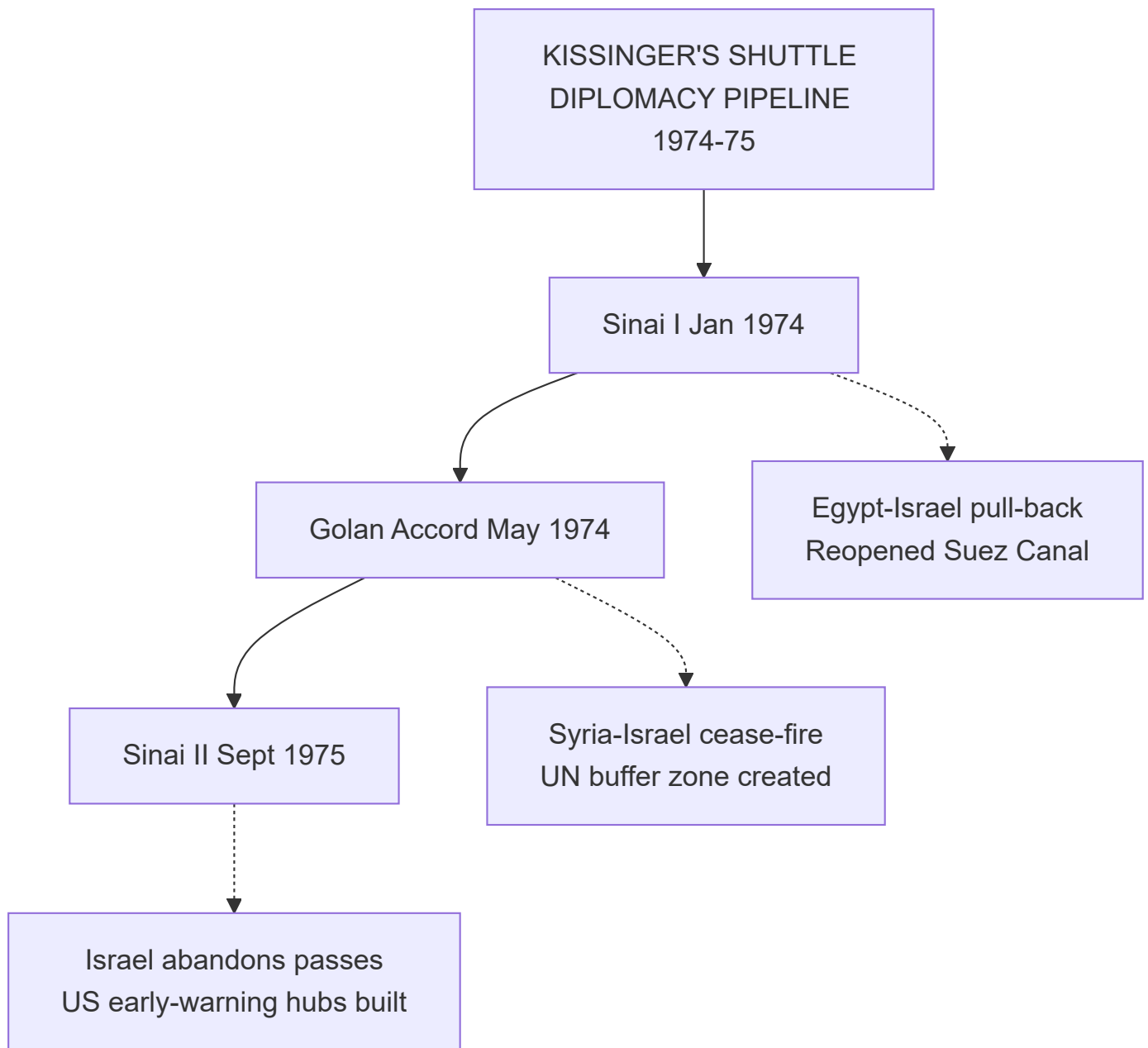
United States Peace
Incentive

Economy severely
damaged by inflation and
fuel shortages
Realized they must
stabilize the Middle East to
prevent future oil crises

prevent future oil crises and limit expanding Soviet influence in Egypt and Syria

For the superpowers, the crisis changed the calculation of Middle Eastern diplomacy. The Yom Kippur War had brought the United States and the Soviet Union to the brink of a nuclear confrontation. The United States, badly hit by the embargo, now had a powerful financial incentive to broker a lasting peace between Israel and its Arab neighbors to ensure the stable flow of Middle Eastern oil. Furthermore, US policymakers wanted to use diplomatic negotiations to pull Egypt out of the Soviet sphere of influence. Because Egypt and Syria refused to meet face-to-face with Israeli officials, US Secretary of State Henry Kissinger stepped in as a mediator. Kissinger pioneered a form of negotiation known as "shuttle diplomacy," flying back and forth between Cairo, Damascus, and Tel Aviv for two months to relay messages, draft proposals, and bridge the deep psychological divide between the hostile states.

Q1. How did the 1973 Yom Kippur War change the diplomatic calculations of the United States?



Kissinger's efforts produced three highly important interim agreements. The Sinai I Agreement (January 1974) saw Israeli forces pull back from the west bank of the Suez Canal, creating a UN-patrolled buffer zone. The Golan Accord (May 1974) brokered a cease-fire line on the Golan Heights, with Israel withdrawing from Quneitra. The Sinai II Agreement (September 1975) saw Israel surrender the strategic Gidi and Mitla passes and the vital Abu Rudeis oil fields to Egypt. Crucially, the US established manned early-warning electronic monitoring stations in Sinai to guarantee compliance. A direct consequence of Kissinger's Sinai I agreement was the clearing of the Suez Canal. The canal had been blocked since the 1967 Six Day War by sunken ships and landmines. On 5 June 1975—exactly eight years to the day after its closure—President Anwar Sadat officially reopened the Suez Canal to international trade, providing a major boost to the Egyptian economy.

Q2. What was the result of Henry Kissinger's Sinai II Agreement (September 1975)?

By 1977, the momentum of Kissinger's shuttle diplomacy had stalled. In May 1977, the right-wing Likud bloc came to power in Israel, with Menachem Begin installed as Prime Minister. Begin firmly believed in Israel's biblical claim to the entire Land of Israel, including the West Bank. Most observers assumed Begin's election

would end all hopes of peace.

Sadat faces economic
collapse & riots



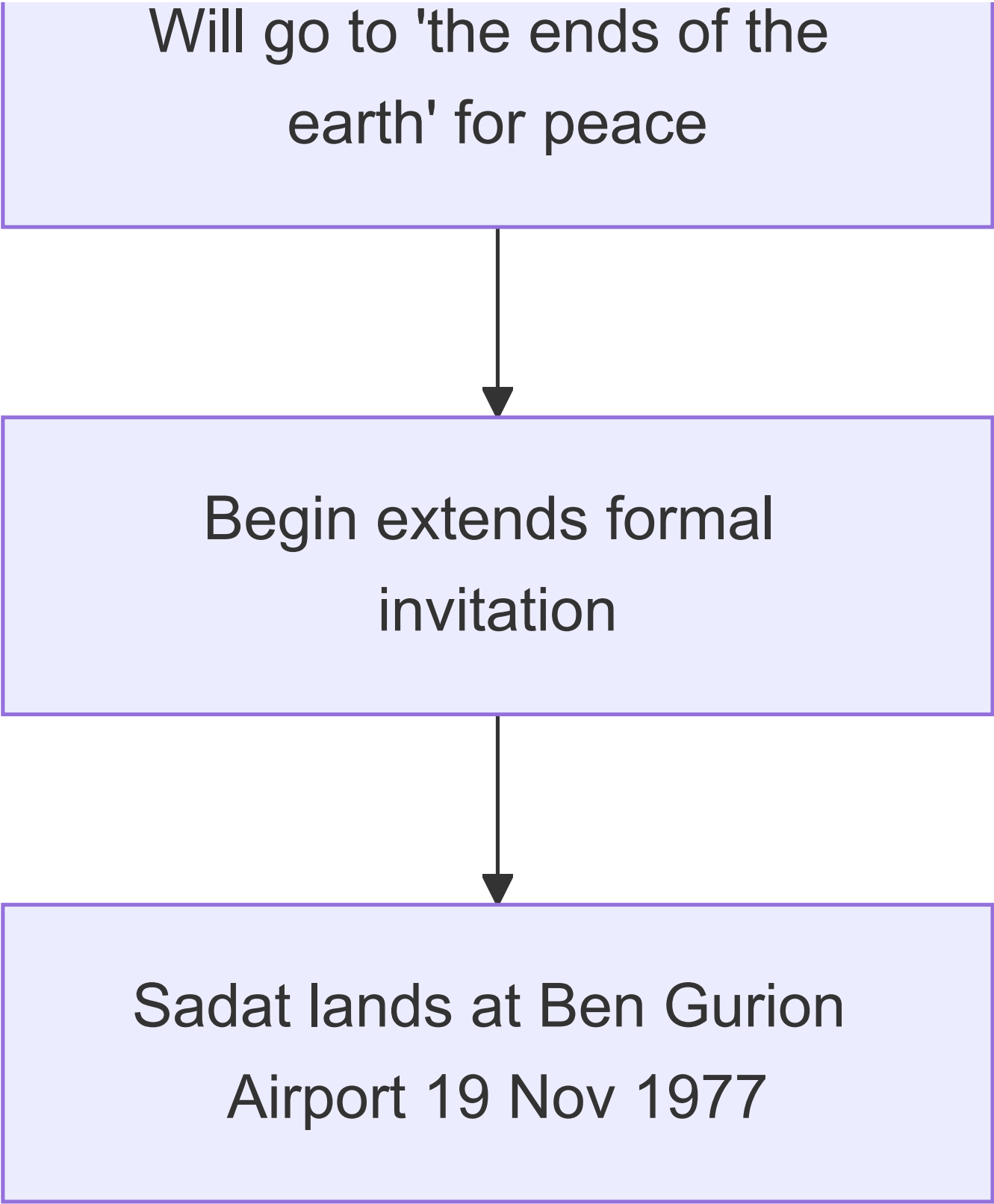
Realises conventional war
is too costly



Declares to Egyptian
Parliament



Will go to 'the ends of the
earth' for peace



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graph TD; A[Will go to 'the ends of the earth' for peace] --> B[Begin extends formal invitation]; B --> C[Sadat lands at Ben Gurion Airport 19 Nov 1977];
```

Begin extends formal
invitation

Sadat lands at Ben Gurion
Airport 19 Nov 1977

However, Anwar Sadat was facing severe internal pressures, a failing economy, and food riots in Cairo. Sadat realized only a dramatic, direct gesture could break the diplomatic deadlock. On 19 November 1977, Sadat's presidential plane landed at Ben Gurion Airport in Israel. The following day, he addressed the Israeli Knesset, offering Israel complete recognition and permanent peace in exchange for complete Israeli withdrawal from all occupied Arab lands. By mid-1978, direct talks between Egypt and Israel had once again broken down over Begin's refusal to dismantle Jewish settlements in the Sinai. To rescue the process, US President Jimmy Carter took a massive political risk, inviting both Sadat and Begin to the presidential retreat at Camp David, Maryland, for face-to-face negotiations.

Q3. What dramatic gesture did Anwar Sadat make on 19 November 1977 to break the diplomatic deadlock?

THE CAMP DAVID SUMMIT SEPT 1978

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graph TD; A[THE CAMP DAVID SUMMIT SEPT 1978] --> B[13 Days of Seclusion]; B --> C[Jimmy Carter's Mediation]; C --> D[Two Framework Agreements];
```

13 Days of Seclusion

Jimmy Carter's Mediation

Two Framework
Agreements

For 13 days, Carter acted as a tireless mediator. The grueling summit resulted in the signing of the Camp David Accords on 17 September 1978. Framework 1 addressed the wider Palestinian issue, agreeing to a five-year transitional period of autonomy for the West Bank and Gaza Strip. Framework 2 outlined a bilateral peace treaty: Israel agreed to a phased, complete withdrawal from the Sinai Peninsula, and Egypt agreed to normalise relations. On 26 March 1979, Begin, Sadat, and Carter signed the formal Treaty of Peace between Egypt and Israel (the Treaty of Washington). Israel returned the entire Sinai Peninsula to Egypt, which became demilitarised. In return, Egypt officially recognized Israel's right to exist, becoming the first Arab nation to do so. The Suez Canal and the Straits of Tiran were permanently open to Israeli maritime shipping.

Q4. Outline the key terms of Framework 2 of the 1978 Camp David Accords.

Sinai returned to Egypt
phased



Egypt grants diplomatic
recognition to Israel



Sinai demilitarised &
monitored



Suez Canal & Straits of Tiran fully open to IDF

While celebrated in the West, the peace treaty triggered a massive geopolitical backlash in the Middle East. The Arab League expelled Egypt for abandoning the Palestinian cause. Tragically, on 6 October 1981, Anwar Sadat was assassinated by radical Islamic militants within the Egyptian army who opposed his peace with Israel. Begin also faced furious opposition from hardline settlers, but the Knesset approved the treaty with a massive majority of 84 votes to 19.

Q5. What was the tragic personal consequence for Anwar Sadat following the signing of the peace treaty?

Q6. Explain one consequence of the 1973 Oil Crisis for diplomatic negotiations in the Middle East. (4 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Was Anwar Sadat a courageous visionary or a traitor to the Arab cause? Justify your view.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Explain one consequence of the Camp David Accords (1978). (4 marks)

Exam Practice

1. Explain the importance of Kissinger's 'shuttle diplomacy' for relations between Israel and Egypt. (8 marks)

2. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of 1974-1979 that led to peace between Egypt and Israel. (8 marks)

4. Explain one consequence of the reopening of the Suez Canal, 1975. (4 marks)

6. Explain one consequence of the Camp David Agreements (1978-79). (4 marks)

3. Write a narrative account analysing key developments in diplomatic negotiations in the years 1973-79. (8 marks)

5. Explain the importance of Sadat's visit to Israel, 1977, for diplomatic negotiations. (8 marks)

7. Explain the importance of US President Carter and Camp David, 1978, for the peace process in the Middle East. (8 marks)

8. Explain the importance of the Treaty of Washington (1978-79) for peace in the Middle East. (8 marks)

Documentary / General Notes

Title / Topic: _____

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

KT3.2: The Palestinian Issue, 1974–1993

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand Arafat's speech to the UN (1974) and the significance of PLO activities in Lebanon.
- ☐ Analyze Israeli reprisals, the invasion of Lebanon (1982) and the results.
- ☐ Evaluate the situation in the Israeli occupied territories and the First Palestinian Intifada (1987–93).

While Egypt and Israel made peace, the Palestinians felt abandoned. Operating out of Lebanon, the PLO launched relentless attacks against Israel, leading to the devastating 1982 Israeli invasion of Lebanon. By 1987, Palestinian frustration inside the occupied territories exploded into a spontaneous, grassroots uprising known as the First Intifada.

Did you know?

- Lebanon War (1982): Israel invaded Lebanon to destroy the PLO, resulting in thousands of civilian casualties.
- Intifada (1987): Meaning 'shaking off', this was a massive Palestinian uprising in the West Bank and Gaza involving strikes and stone-throwing.
- Hamas: Formed during the Intifada, this militant Islamic group emerged as a rival to the secular PLO.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. Who was the US Secretary of State who pioneered the stage-by-step mediation strategy known as 'shuttle diplomacy' following the 1973 Yom Kippur War?

2. In what month and year did Egypt officially reopen the Suez Canal to international shipping, exactly eight years to the day after its closure?

3. Explain how the 1973 Oil Crisis acted as a direct catalyst for the United States to become heavily involved in Middle Eastern diplomacy.

4. Which right-wing, revisionist Zionist leader won the May 1977 Israeli election, ending nearly thirty years of Labor Party dominance?

5. Explain how Anwar Sadat's historic visit to Jerusalem in November 1977 broke a decades-long Arab diplomatic taboo.

6. Name the two distinct framework agreements that comprised the Camp David Accords signed on 17 September 1978.

7. Detail the primary bilateral terms of the Treaty of Washington signed on 26 March 1979.

8. How did the wider Arab world react to Egypt signing a separate peace treaty with Israel in 1979?

9. Explain the domestic backlash and political fallout that both Anwar Sadat and Menachem Begin faced within their own countries after signing the peace agreements.

10. Using a relative clause and an analytical linking phrase, write a single sentence showing how the 1973 Oil Crisis historically connected to the Treaty of Washington (1979).

Vocabulary Check

Style: Mini-Frayer Model

Complete the Frayer Model for the term: **UN Resolution 3236**

Definition	Historical Example
Non-Example / Sketch	Your own sentence

The First Intifada (1987)



Palestinian youth confronting Israeli troops during the First Intifada, a spontaneous grassroots uprising.

Israeli Response to the Intifada



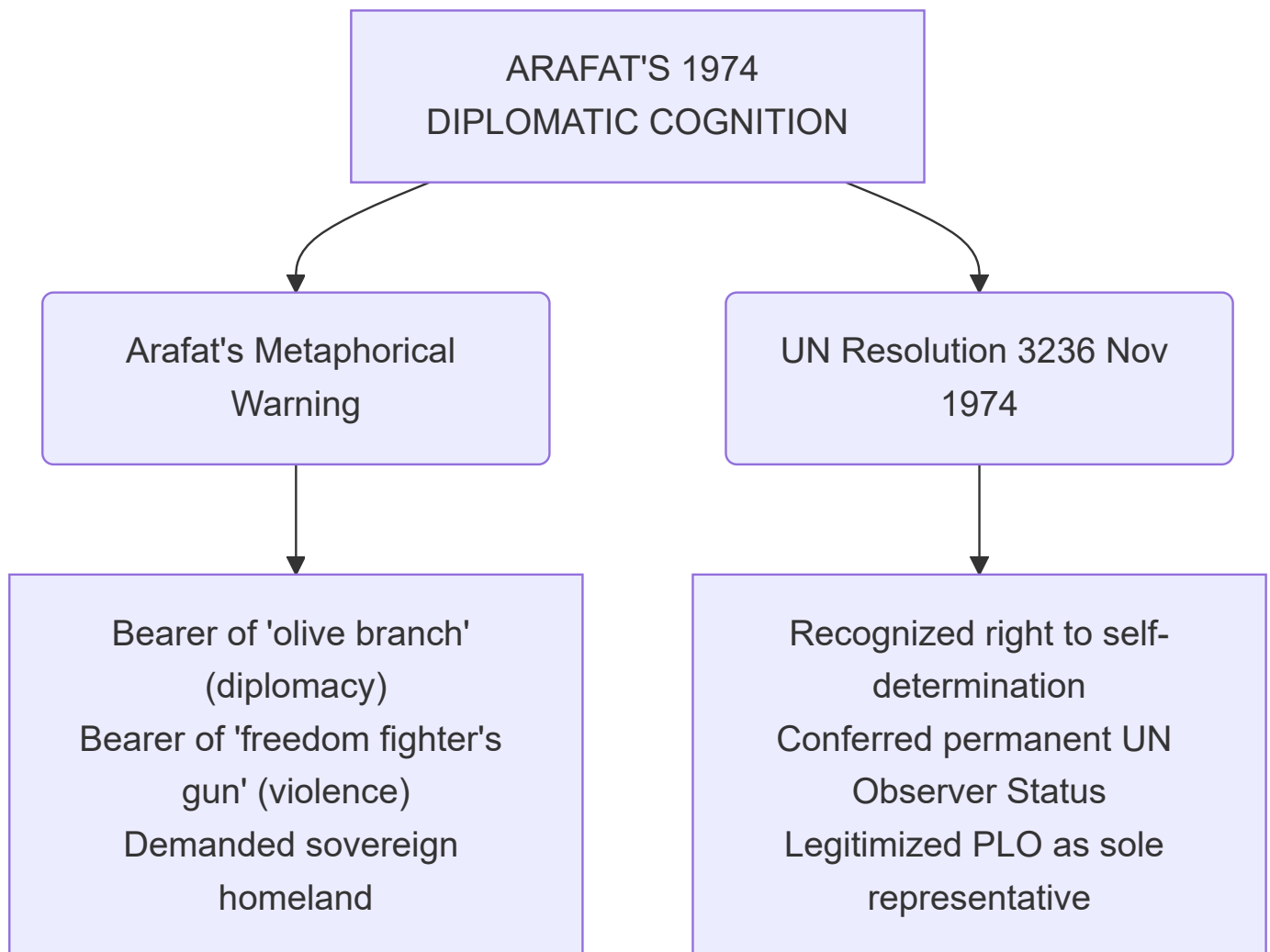
Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Shamir, who implemented a harsh 'Iron Fist' policy in response to the Intifada.

PLO Exile in Lebanon

 Source

Yasser Arafat, leader of the PLO, whose organization was forced into exile in Tunisia following the 1982 Lebanon War.

Following the 1973 Yom Kippur War, the Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) sought to capitalize on the shifting geopolitical landscape to advance its diplomatic standing. On 13 November 1974, PLO Chairman Yasser Arafat made a historic address to the United Nations General Assembly in New York. This invitation was highly significant, representing the first time a representative of a non-state national movement was permitted to address the UN General Assembly plenary. Arafat, who delivered his speech wearing his signature checkered keffiyeh and olive-green uniform, famously concluded his remarks with a powerful metaphorical warning: "I have come bearing an olive branch and a freedom fighter's gun. Do not let the olive branch fall from my hand."



This dual-track message signaled that while the PLO was prepared to engage in international diplomacy to secure a sovereign Palestinian state, it would not abandon its armed struggle if diplomatic avenues were blocked. The diplomatic offensive yielded immediate results at the UN. Resolution 3236 formally recognized the inalienable rights of the Palestinian people to self-determination, and granted the PLO permanent Observer Status. At the Arab League Summit in Algiers, the PLO was officially recognized as the "sole legitimate representative of the Palestinian nation." Following its bloody expulsion from Jordan during the "Black September" civil war of 1970, the PLO relocated its central leadership, military apparatus, and thousands of fighters to Lebanon. Lebanon was an ideal haven: its central government in Beirut was weak, and the country already hosted over 400,000 Palestinian refugees living in camps.

Q1. What was the significance of UN Resolution 3236 (November 1974) for the PLO?

THE RISE OF 'FATAHLAND' IN LEBANON



PLO Expelled from Jordan
1970



PLO Establishes HQ in
Southern Lebanon



Cross-Border Katyusha
Rocket Attacks



Galilee Settlements
Targeted



1975 Lebanese Civil War
Erupts



PLO Allies with Leftist

Muslim Coalition

By the mid-1970s, the PLO had established a powerful "state-within-a-state" in southern Lebanon, widely known as "Fatahland". The PLO operated its own checkpoints, collected taxes, ran hospitals, and established military training camps. From these bases, PLO guerrilla fighters launched cross-border raids and fired Katyusha rocket barrages into northern Israel, terrorizing the civilian settlements of the Galilee region. On 11 March 1978, a Fatah commando unit launched the Coastal Road Massacre, hijacking a civilian bus and engaging in a gun battle that resulted in the deaths of 37 Israeli civilians. In direct retaliation, Prime Minister Menachem Begin ordered the IDF to launch Operation Litani on 15 March 1978.

Q2. What was 'Fatahland' and how did it threaten Israeli security?

Fatah Coastal Road
Massacre 37 Dead



Operation Litani Launched
March 1978



IDF Occupies Southern
Lebanon Buffer Zone



UN Security Council Resolution 425



UNIFIL Deployed to Border



Israel Builds South
Lebanon Army SLA Militia

Over 26,000 IDF troops invaded southern Lebanon, occupying a 10-kilometer-wide security strip. The UN established the United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL) to confirm the Israeli withdrawal. Israel withdrew but left control of the buffer zone to a friendly, pro-Israeli Christian militia known as the South Lebanon Army (SLA). The UNIFIL buffer failed to stop the conflict. The final trigger for full-scale war occurred on 3 June 1982, when the Abu Nidal Organization shot and critically wounded Shlomo Argov, Israel's ambassador to Great Britain. Although British intelligence confirmed the PLO was not responsible, Israeli Defense Minister Ariel Sharon used the assassination attempt as the necessary pretext to launch a long-planned, total invasion of Lebanon: Operation Peace for Galilee.

Q3. What pretext did Israeli Defense Minister Ariel Sharon use to launch Operation Peace for Galilee in June 1982?

THE 1982 LEBANESE INVASION

```
graph TD; A[THE 1982 LEBANESE INVASION] --> B[Ambassador Shlomo Argov Shot 3 June]; B --> C[Operation Peace for Galilee 6 June]; C --> D[ ];
```

Ambassador Shlomo Argov
Shot 3 June

Operation Peace for
Galilee 6 June



IDF Bypasses UNIFIL and
Races North



Heavy Syrian Air Clashes
100 MiGs Shot Down



Siege of West Beirut
Encirclement



14,000 PLO Fighters

Evacuated to Tunis

On 6 June 1982, Israeli forces launched a massive armored invasion. Ariel Sharon secretly harbored much larger geopolitical ambitions: to completely destroy the PLO in Lebanon, defeat Syrian forces, and install a pro-Israeli Christian government in Beirut led by Maronite leader Bashir Gemayel. By mid-June, Israeli forces surrounded Lebanon's capital, trapping Yasser Arafat and 15,000 PLO fighters in West Beirut. For over two months, Israel subjected the city to relentless bombardments. To prevent total destruction, a multinational peacekeeping force supervised the evacuation of Yasser Arafat and over 14,000 fighters by ship to Tunis, Tunisia.

Q4. What were Ariel Sharon's larger geopolitical ambitions behind the 1982 invasion of Lebanon?

Having successfully expelled the PLO, Israel's close Maronite ally, Bashir Gemayel, was elected President of Lebanon. However, on 14 September 1982, Gemayel was assassinated in a massive bomb blast by Syrian agents.

Bashir Gemayel
Assassinated 14 Sept



IDF Encirclement of Sabra
& Shatila Camps



Phalangist Militias Allowed
Into Camps



**Three-Day Brutal
Massacre of Civilians**

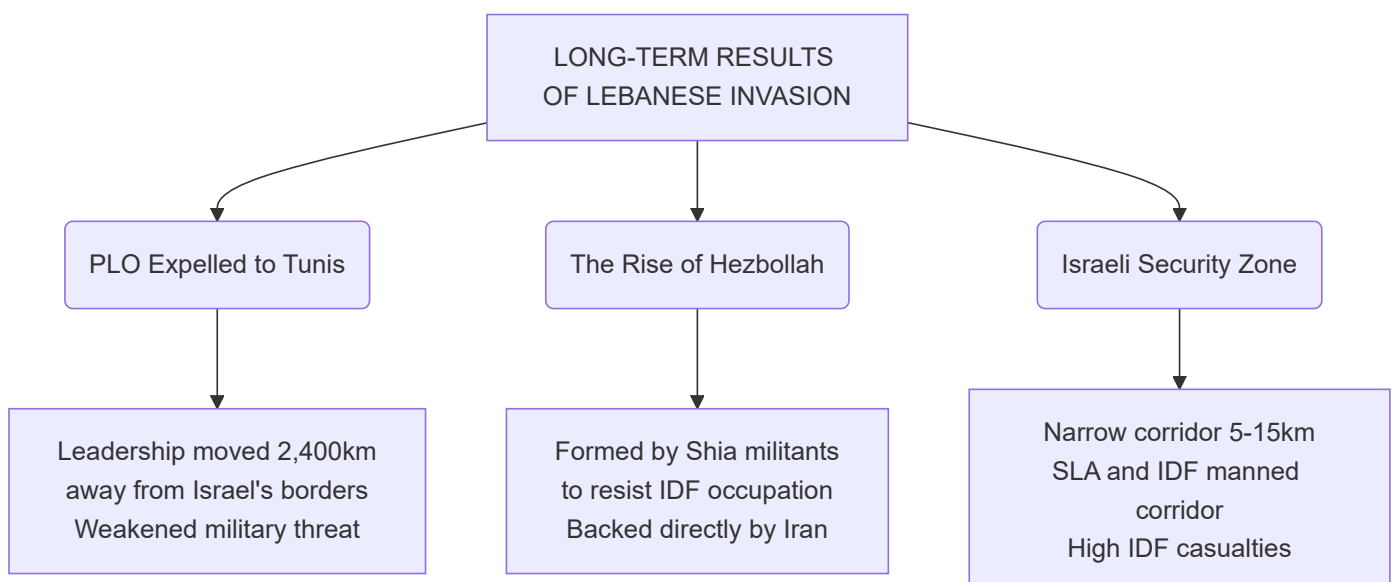
```
graph TD; A[Three-Day Brutal Massacre of Civilians] --> B[Global Outrage & Kahan Commission]; B --> C[Ariel Sharon Forced to Resign];
```

**Global Outrage & Kahan
Commission**

**Ariel Sharon Forced to
Resign**

In response to the assassination, the IDF occupied West Beirut. On 16 September 1982, Israeli forces surrounded the Palestinian refugee camps of Sabra and Shatila. Claiming PLO terrorists remained inside, Ariel Sharon authorized the Lebanese Christian Phalangist militias to enter the camps to clear them. Fueled by anger over the death of Gemayel, the Phalangists systematically slaughtered unarmed civilians. While the IDF held the perimeter and illuminated the night skies with flares, the militias murdered between 800 and 3,500 people. The revelation of the atrocities triggered immediate, furious international condemnation. The extraparliamentary peace movement "Peace Now" organized a protest of 400,000 Israelis in Tel Aviv. The Kahan Commission concluded that Defense Minister Ariel Sharon bore "personal, indirect responsibility" for the tragedy. He was forced to resign.

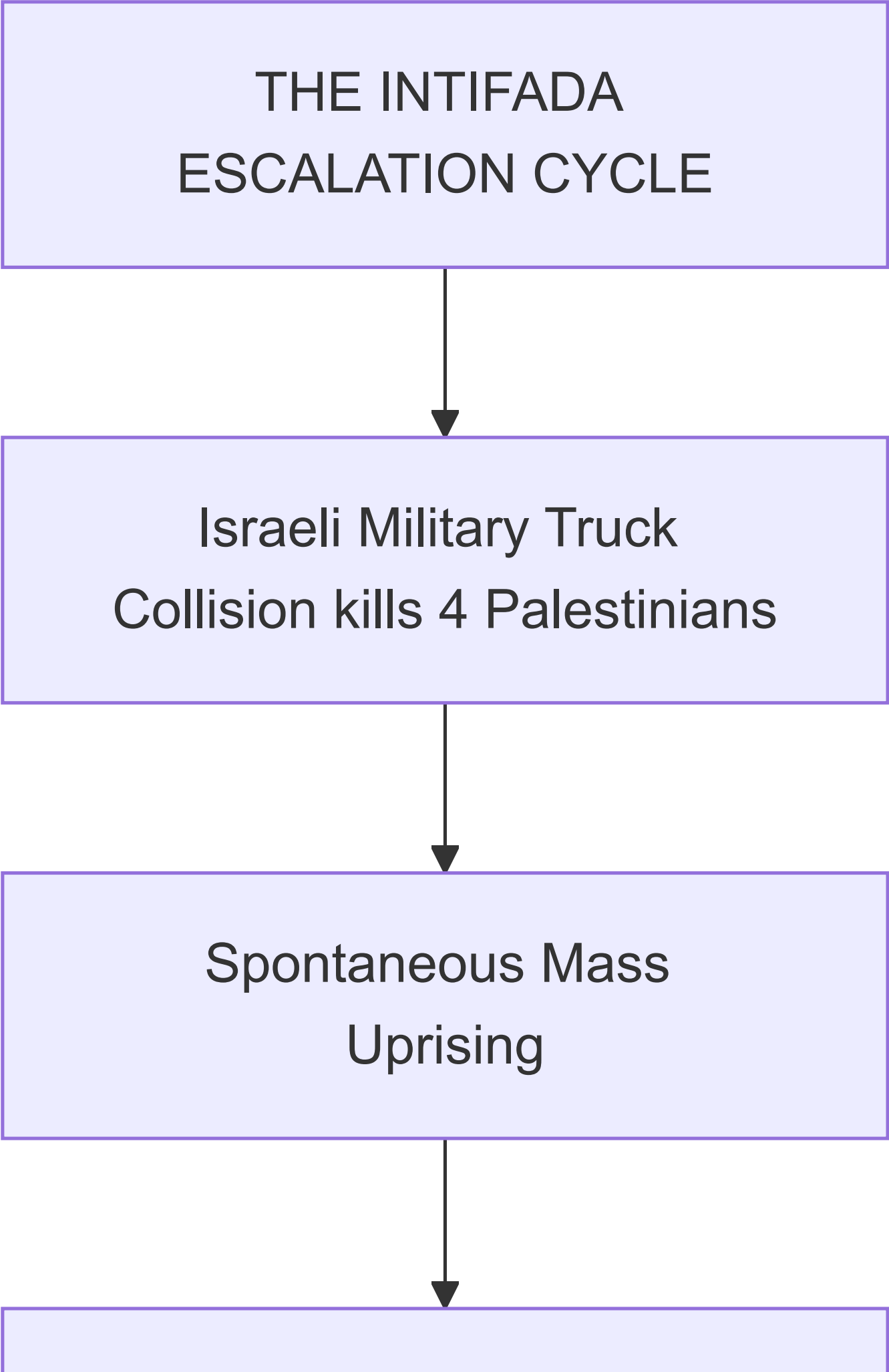
Q5. Describe the events and consequences of the Sabra and Shatila massacre in September 1982.



While the PLO leadership remained isolated in Tunis, the core of the Palestinian struggle shifted back to the occupied territories. On 8 December 1987, an Israeli military truck collided with a civilian car, killing four Palestinians. The local population erupted in massive demonstrations that swept across Gaza and the West Bank, marking the start of the First Palestinian Intifada ("The Shaking Off").

Q6. What event marked the start of the First Palestinian Intifada in December 1987?

THE INTIFADA ESCALATION CYCLE



```
graph TD; A[THE INTIFADA ESCALATION CYCLE] --> B[Israeli Military Truck Collision kills 4 Palestinians]; B --> C[Spontaneous Mass Uprising]; C --> D[ ];
```

The diagram illustrates the Intifada Escalation Cycle as a four-stage process. It begins with a title box, followed by a box describing a triggering event (an Israeli military truck collision), then a box for the resulting spontaneous mass uprising, and finally a fourth, empty box at the bottom, suggesting a continuation of the cycle.

Israeli Military Truck
Collision kills 4 Palestinians

Spontaneous Mass
Uprising



Grassroots Civil
Disobedience & Stone
Throwing



Yitzhak Rabin's 'Iron Fist'
Reprisal



Global Sympathy Shifts to
Palestinian Cause



—

Emergence of Militant Hamas

Unlike the PLO operations, the First Intifada was a grassroots, popular civilian uprising utilizing non-violent civil disobedience (strikes, boycotts) alongside low-level street violence. The iconic visual of the Intifada consisted of Palestinian youth throwing stones at heavily armored Israeli tanks. Israeli Defense Minister Yitzhak Rabin responded with a severe "Iron Fist" policy, ordering the IDF to "break the bones" of demonstrators. However, television cameras broadcasted graphic footage of heavily armed soldiers beating stone-throwing children across the globe. For the first time, global public sympathy shifted decisively toward the Palestinian cause, severely damaging Israel's international moral standing.

Q7. How did the First Intifada shift global public sympathy toward the Palestinian cause?

CONSEQUENCES OF THE FIRST INTIFADA

For the PLO	For Israel	The Rise of Hamas
Forced Yasser Arafat to renounce terrorism and officially accept the two-state solution (1988) to retain leadership.	Convinced Yitzhak Rabin and military planners that there was no purely military solution to the Palestinian issue.	Formed in 1987 as a rival to the PLO, Hamas rejected compromises and conducted violent armed attacks against Israelis.

Writing Historically: Level 9 Stylistic Masterclass

GCSE history examiners actively look for clear, sophisticated written expression that demonstrates analytical links between historical causes, events, and consequences.

- **1. Using Relative Clauses to Pack in Evidence (AO1):** Add vital historical information directly to a noun using relative pronouns like 'who', 'which', or 'whose'. For example: *Yasser Arafat, **who addressed the UN General Assembly in 1974 wearing his signature keffiyeh and military uniform**, successfully secured international legitimacy...*
- **2. Using Noun Phrases in Apposition (AO1):** Place two noun phrases side-by-side to provide concise historical detail. For example: *Ariel Sharon, **the hardline Israeli Defense Minister**, launched Operation Peace for Galilee in June 1982.*
- **3. Using Present Participles (AO2):** Link cause and effect using verbs ending in '-ing'. For example: *...Palestinian guerrillas launched frequent cross-border attacks, **provoking** disproportionate Israeli military reprisals.*

Q8. Write a narrative account analysing the key developments of the PLO in Lebanon in the years 1970–82. (8 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Why was the First Intifada more damaging to Israel's international reputation than their previous wars with Arab armies?

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the First Intifada (1987–1993). (8 marks)

Planning your narrative account:

Remember to link your paragraphs chronologically. You could use these sentence starters:

- *The first key event was...*
- *This directly led to...*
- *Consequently, this triggered...*
- *This situation culminated in...*

Lined area for writing the narrative account.

Exam Practice

1. Explain the importance of Yasser Arafat's speech to the UN, 1974, for the international recognition of the Palestinian cause. (8 marks)

2. Explain the importance of PLO activity in Lebanon for Israel. (8 marks)

4. Explain one consequence of the 1982 Israeli invasion of Lebanon. (4 marks)

6. Explain one consequence of the Palestinian Intifada (1987–93). (4 marks)

3. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of Israel's escalating conflict with the PLO in Lebanon 1978–1982. (8 marks)

5. Explain the importance of the First Intifada (1987-93) for the Palestinians and Israel. (8 marks)

Documentary / General Notes

Title / Topic: _____

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

KT3.3: Attempts at a solution, 1988–1995

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the significance of Arafat's renunciation of terrorism in a speech at the UN (1988).
- ☐ Analyze changing superpower policies in the Middle East: US involvement in the Gulf War (1991), and the end of the Cold War.
- ☐ Evaluate Arafat, Rabin and the Oslo Accords (1993); the setting up of the Palestinian National Authority; the Israel-Jordan peace treaty (1994); and Oslo II (1995).

The sheer exhaustion of the Intifada forced both sides to the negotiating table in secret. In 1993, the world watched in awe as PLO Chairman Yasser Arafat and Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin shook hands on the White House lawn, signing the Oslo Accords. It seemed peace was finally possible, but extremists on both sides were determined to destroy it.

Did you know?

- Oslo Accords (1993): Created the Palestinian Authority with limited self-rule in parts of the West Bank and Gaza.
- Mutual Recognition: The PLO finally recognised Israel's right to exist, and Israel recognised the PLO as the representative of the Palestinians.
- Assassination of Rabin (1995): A right-wing Israeli extremist assassinated Yitzhak Rabin, severely derailing the peace process.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. What was the famous metaphor Yasser Arafat used in his historic 1974 address to the United Nations General Assembly?

2. What major diplomatic status did the UN General Assembly award the PLO under Resolution 3236 following Arafat's speech?

3. Why did the PLO choose to relocate its central headquarters and fighters to Lebanon after being expelled from Jordan in 1970–71?

4. What was 'Fatahland,' and how did its existence affect northern Israeli security?

5. Explain the short-term trigger that Ariel Sharon used as a pretext to launch the June 1982 invasion of Lebanon.

6. Following the Siege of Beirut in August 1982, where were Yasser Arafat and the PLO leadership evacuated to under international supervision?

7. Why did the Israeli Kahan Commission (1983) find Defense Minister Ariel Sharon 'indirectly responsible' for the Sabra and Shatila massacre?

8. What spontaneous event in December 1987 served as the immediate catalyst for the outbreak of the First Palestinian Intifada?

9. Describe the civilian tactics of the First Intifada and explain why Yitzhak Rabin's military response backfired internationally.

10. Write an analytical sentence linking the First Palestinian Intifada to the emergence of Hamas.

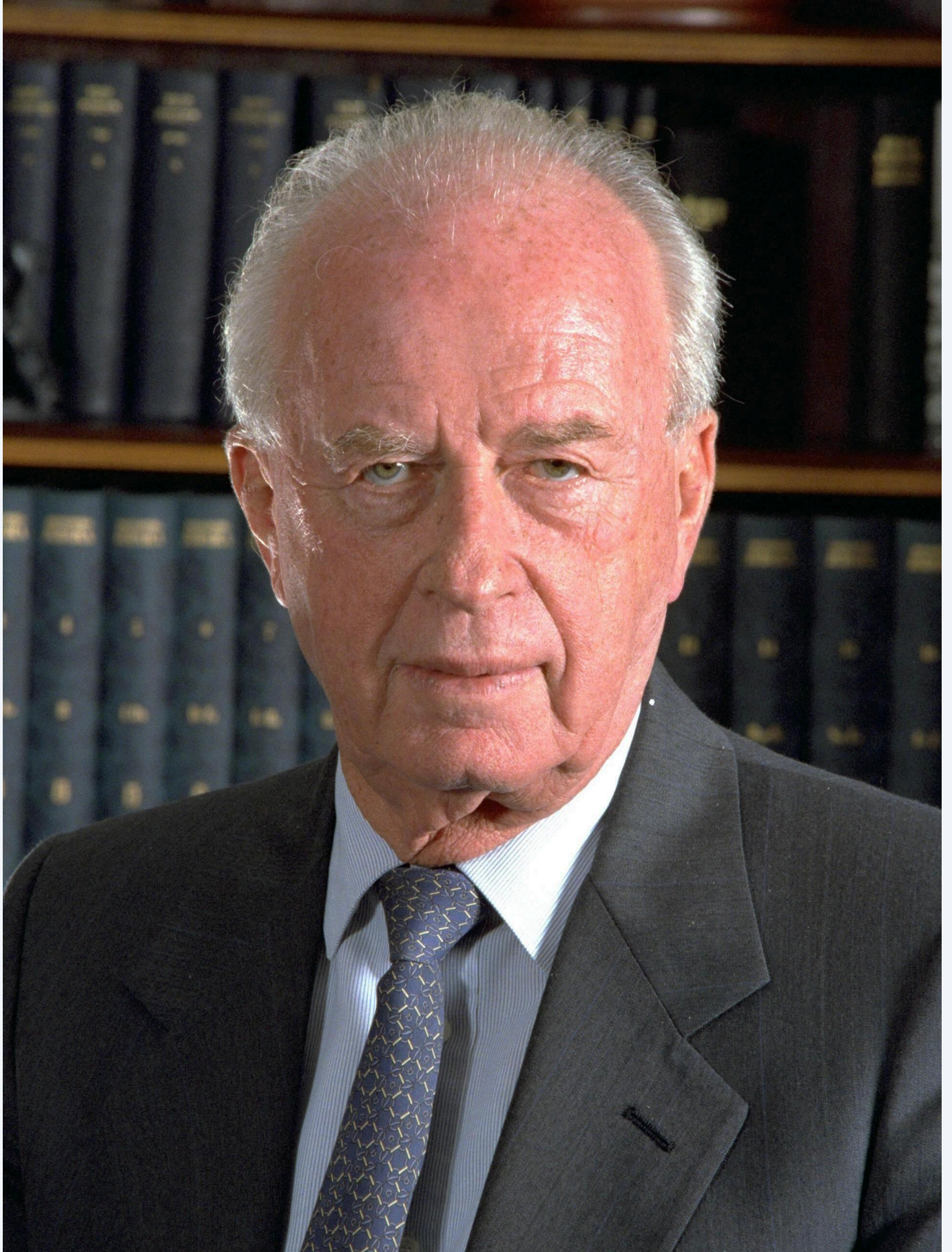
Vocabulary Check

Style: Vocabulary in Context

Write a short paragraph using at least *FOUR* of the vocabulary words below correctly.

UNLU | Two-state solution | Madrid Conference | Oslo I Accords | Oslo II Accords | Yigal Amir

The Oslo Handshake (1993)

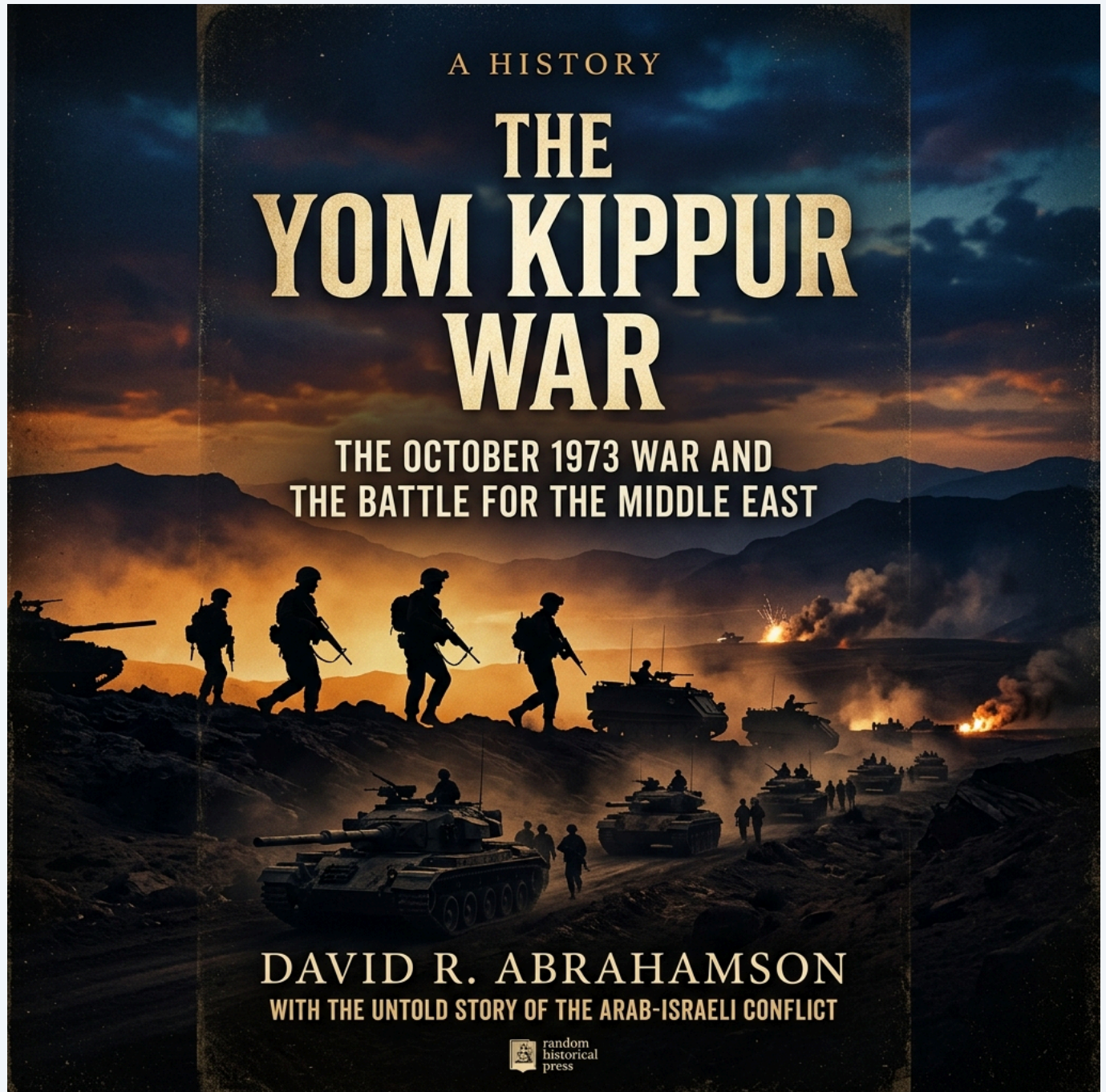


Yitzhak Rabin, Yasser Arafat, and Bill Clinton sealing the Oslo I Accord on the White House lawn.

Israel-Jordan Peace Treaty (1994)

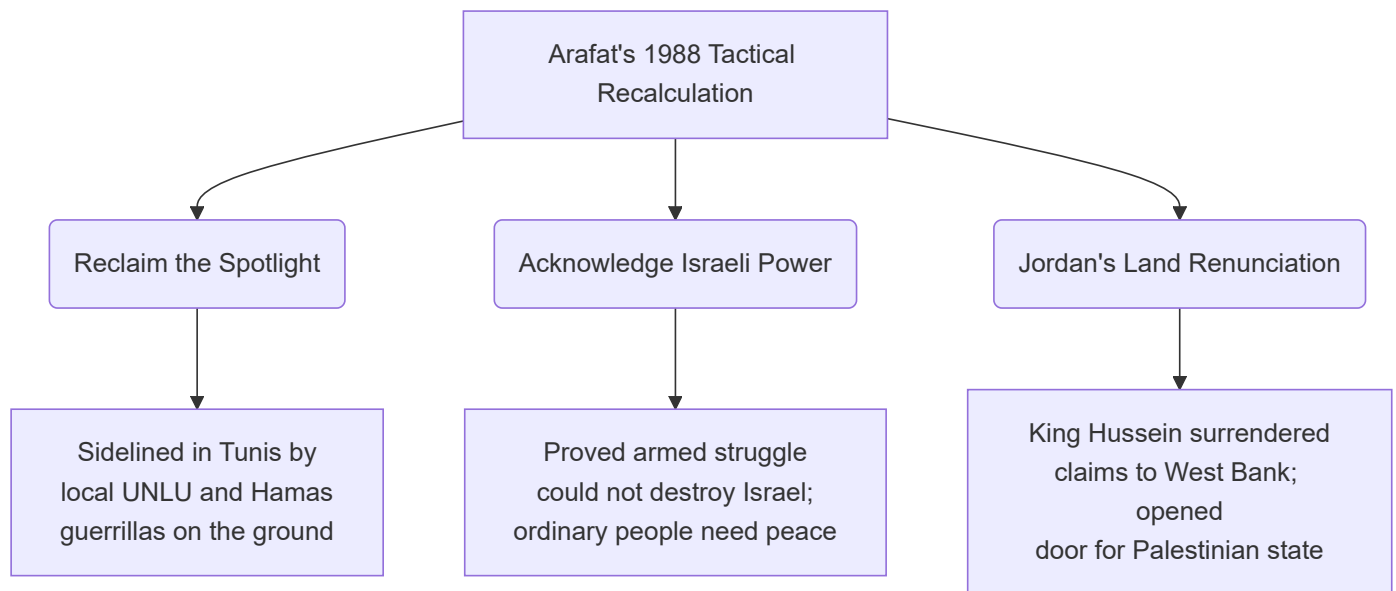


King Hussein of Jordan, who signed the historic peace treaty with Israel in 1994, normalizing relations between the two countries.



The book cover of 'Yitzhak Rabin: Soldier, Leader, Statesman' depicting Rabin, who was assassinated by an Israeli extremist at a Tel Aviv peace rally.

By late 1988, PLO Chairman Yasser Arafat realized that the political landscape was shifting beneath his feet. The First Palestinian Intifada had been launched and coordinated by grassroots local committees on the ground, bypassing the traditional PLO leadership isolated in Tunis. Arafat faced a major dilemma: his leadership was being rapidly overshadowed by new, highly popular underground leaders in the Unified National Leadership of the Uprising (UNLU) and radical Islamist groups like Hamas and Islamic Jihad.



To regain political control, Arafat enacted a historic shift in PLO strategy. In November 1988, the Palestinian National Council officially accepted the principles of partition and a two-state solution—officially recognizing Israel’s right to exist alongside a sovereign, independent Palestinian state in the occupied territories. In December 1988, on the strict insistence of the United States, Arafat delivered a historic speech to a special session of the UN General Assembly in Geneva. In this speech, Arafat explicitly renounced and condemned all forms of terrorism. This met the long-standing US conditions for official diplomatic contact, forcing the Reagan administration to open formal diplomatic talks with the PLO.

Q1. How did Yasser Arafat enact a historic shift in PLO strategy in late 1988?

The international geopolitical order was completely transformed between 1989 and 1991. The dissolution of the Soviet Union (USSR) in December 1991 brought an end to the Cold War and fundamentally altered the balance of power in the Middle East.

THE SOVIET COLLAPSE GEOPOLITICAL DOMINO EFFECT



USSR Dissolves Dec 1991



PLO loses main finance &
arms supplier



200000 Soviet Jews
migrate to Israel



Settlement expansion in
West Bank



Unemployed Palestinians
displaced



Arafat pressured to seek

urgent peace

The collapse of the USSR was a devastating blow to the PLO, which lost its primary funding and diplomatic backing. Over 200,000 Soviet Jews migrated to Israel, leading to the expansion of Jewish settlements in the West Bank and displacing Palestinian workers. Arafat realized he had to secure a deal immediately. The end of the Cold War also meant the US emerged as the sole global superpower and used its leverage, threatening to withhold a \$10 billion loan guarantee, to force Israel's Prime Minister Yitzhak Shamir to negotiate. In August 1990, Iraqi dictator Saddam Hussein invaded Kuwait, triggering the 1991 Gulf War. Arafat made the disastrous decision to publicly support Saddam Hussein.

Q2. How did the collapse of the Soviet Union in 1991 severely damage the PLO's geopolitical position?

Arafat backs Saddam
Hussein in Gulf War



Gulf States cut off vital
PLO funding



PLO is diplomatically &
financially isolated



US/USSR co-sponsor
Madrid Conference 1991

```
graph TD; A[US/USSR co-sponsor  
Madrid Conference 1991] --> B[Direct Arab-Israeli talks  
deadlocked]; B --> C[Paves way for secret  
Norwegian channel];
```

Direct Arab-Israeli talks
deadlocked

Paves way for secret
Norwegian channel

Outraged by Arafat's betrayal, wealthy Gulf Arab states cut off all financial donations. Kuwait expelled over 300,000 Palestinian workers. The PLO was left bankrupt. To stabilize the region, the US and USSR co-sponsored the Madrid Peace Conference in November 1991. While the public talks stalemated, they broke the taboo of direct negotiations. In June 1992, the moderate Labor Party came to power in Israel under Yitzhak Rabin. Rabin authorized secret, back-channel negotiations in Oslo, Norway.

Q3. Why was the PLO left bankrupt and diplomatically isolated following the 1991 Gulf War?

Labour Government
elected under Yitzhak Rabin



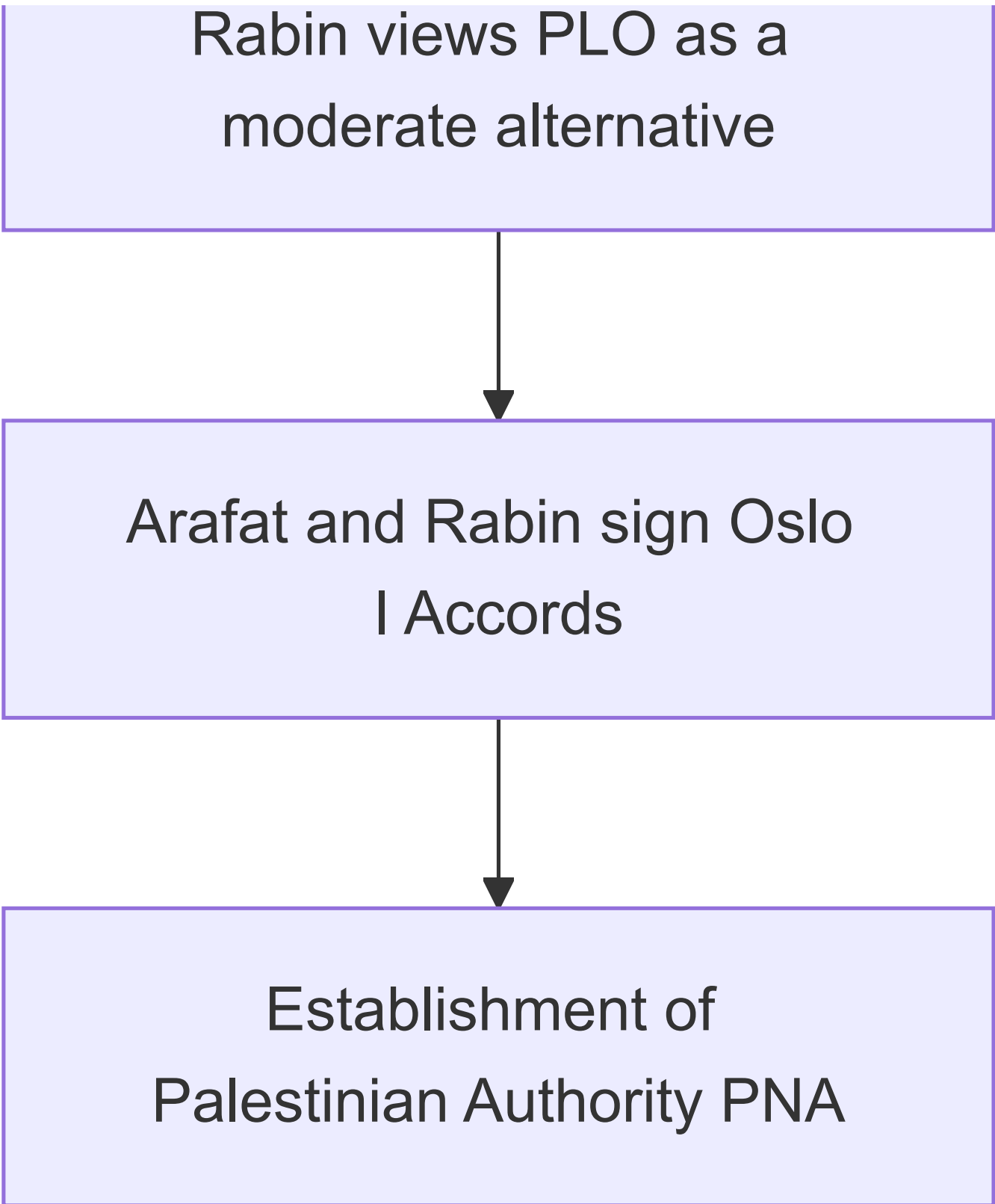
Secret talks opened in
Norway Dec 1992



Hamas launches first
suicide bombings 1993



Rabin views PLO as a
moderate alternative



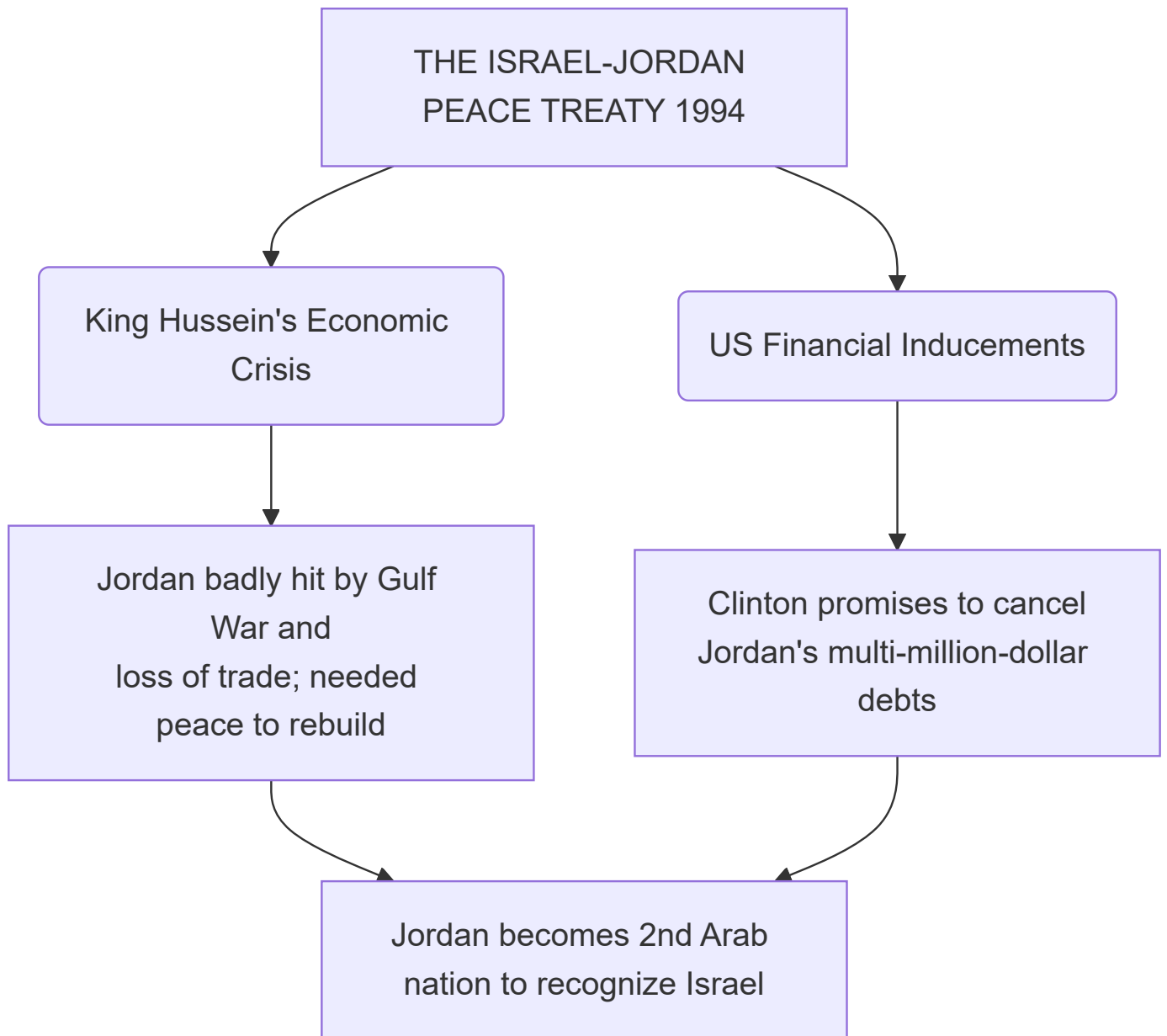
```
graph TD; A[Rabin views PLO as a moderate alternative] --> B[Arafat and Rabin sign Oslo I Accords]; B --> C[Establishment of Palestinian Authority PNA];
```

Arafat and Rabin sign Oslo
I Accords

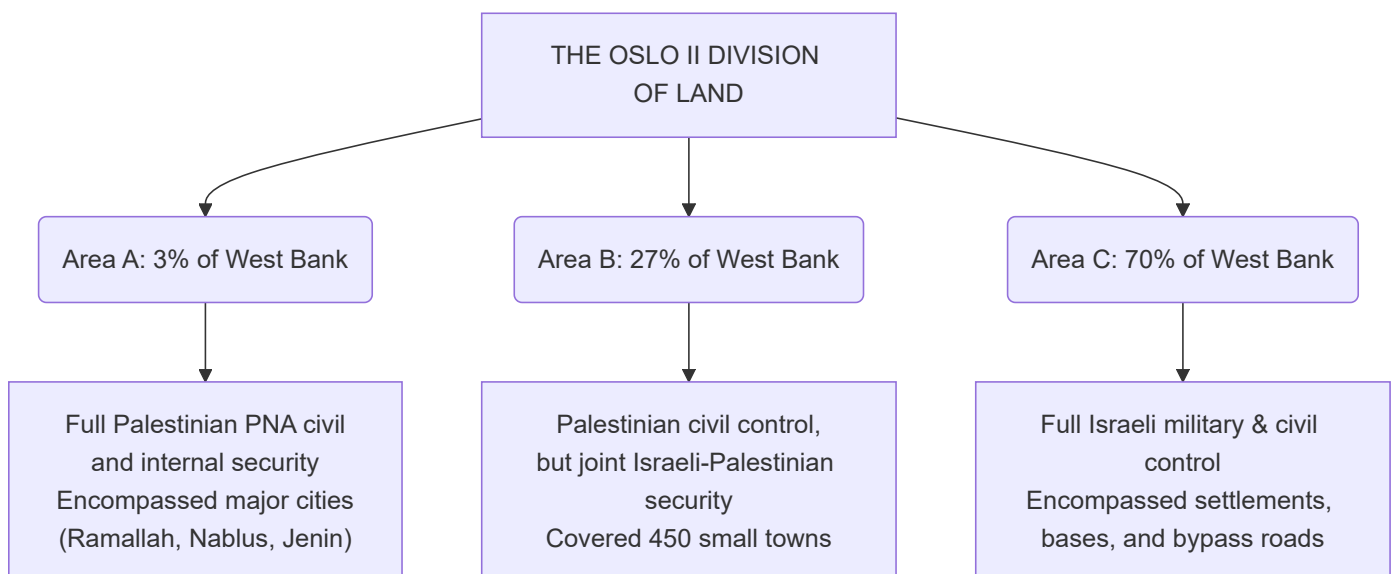
Establishment of
Palestinian Authority PNA

The urgency intensified in April 1993 when Hamas launched its first suicide car bombing. This convinced Rabin that Arafat's PLO was a moderate alternative. The secret negotiations produced the historic Oslo I Accords, signed on the White House lawn on 13 September 1993. Arafat renounced terrorism and recognized Israel, while Rabin recognized the PLO. An interim Palestinian National Authority (PNA) was established to govern Gaza and Jericho. In October 1994, Israel and Jordan signed a formal Treaty of Peace. King Hussein approached Rabin because Jordan was suffering economically after the Gulf War. US President Bill Clinton promised to cancel Jordan's massive debts if it normalized relations.

Q4. What convinced Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin to engage in secret negotiations with the PLO in 1993?

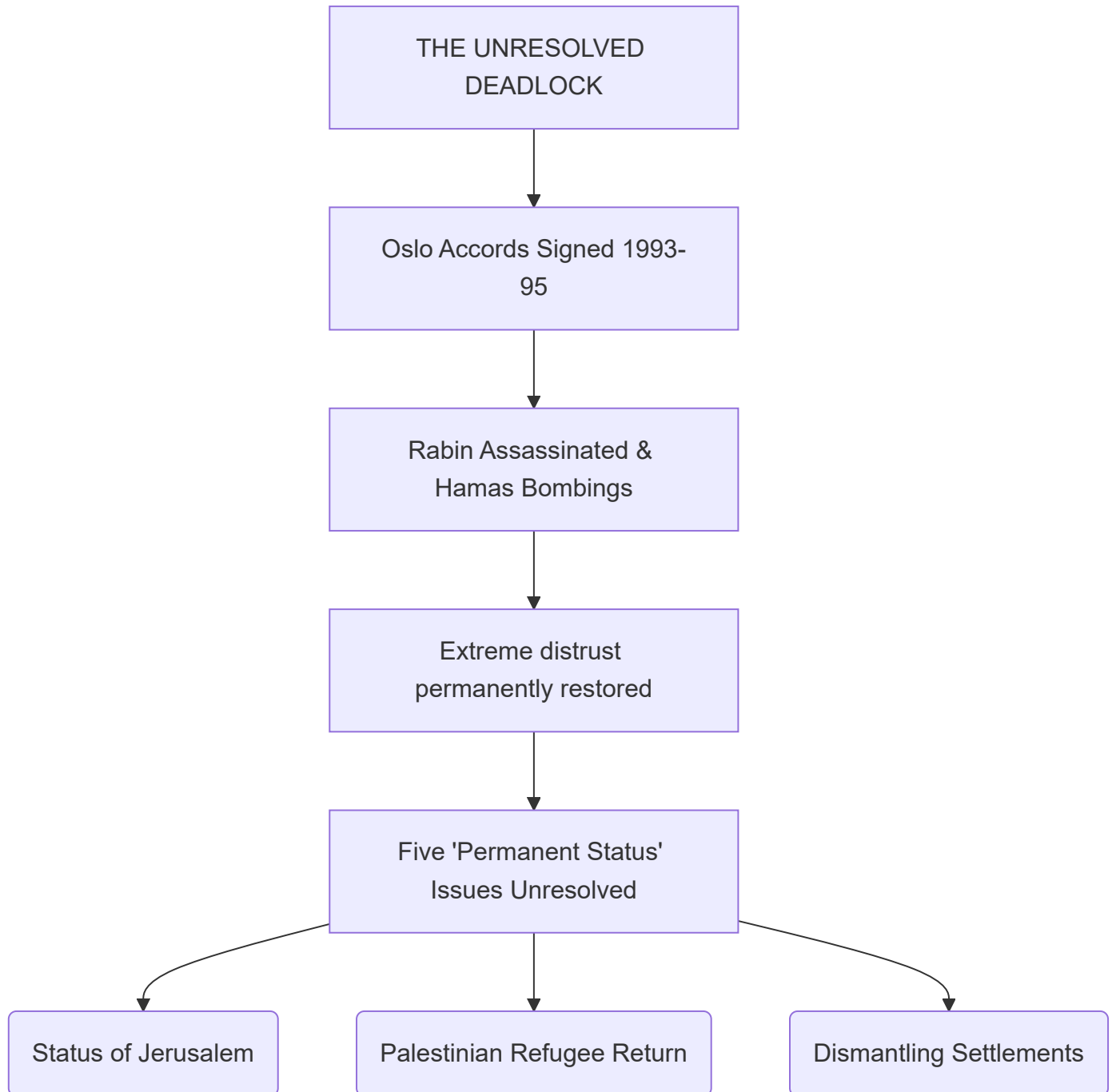


On 28 September 1995, Rabin and Arafat signed the Oslo II Accords, which detailed the expansion of Palestinian self-rule across the West Bank by dividing it into three zones.



While Oslo II was celebrated, the division triggered a massive political backlash. Palestinians were frustrated that the PNA only controlled a fragmented archipelago (Area A), while Israel still controlled 70% of their land (Area C). Hamas launched suicide bus bombings. Right-wing Israelis were outraged by Rabin's concessions.

Q5. Why did the Oslo II Accords trigger a massive political backlash among Palestinians?



On 4 November 1995, Yitzhak Rabin was assassinated at a peace rally in Tel Aviv by Yigal Amir, a radical right-wing Jewish law student. The assassination dealt a fatal blow to the peace process, leaving the "permanent status" issues completely unresolved.

Q6. What event dealt a fatal blow to the peace process on 4 November 1995?

Q7. Write a narrative account analysing the key developments in the peace process between Israel and the Palestinians in the years 1988–95. (8 marks)

The tragic assassination of Rabin highlighted the deep structural flaws of the Oslo Accords. While celebrated internationally as a breakthrough, the agreement was fundamentally ambiguous. It intentionally delayed the most difficult "permanent status" issues—such as the final borders, the status of Jerusalem, the right of return for Palestinian refugees, and the dismantling of Israeli settlements—to a later date. This delay created a dangerous vacuum of uncertainty. Right-wing Israelis viewed any land concessions as a threat to national security and biblical claims, while Palestinian hardliners argued that the PNA had essentially become a subcontractor for Israeli security, failing to deliver true sovereignty or halt settlement expansion. Ultimately, the Accords required a high level of mutual trust that simply did not exist on the ground.

Q8. Explain why the Oslo Accords were considered 'fundamentally ambiguous' and structurally flawed. (12 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Looking at the assassination of Rabin, why are peace agreements sometimes more dangerous for leaders than declaring war?

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

GCSE Exam Practice

Explain the importance of the Oslo I Accord (1993) for the Middle East peace process. (8 marks)

[illegible]

Exam Practice

1. Explain the importance of Yasser Arafat's renunciation of terrorism in 1988 for the peace process. (8 marks)

2. Explain the importance of the first Gulf War and end of the Cold War (1991) for the conflict in the Middle east. (8 marks)

3. Explain one consequence of the Gulf War (1991) for the Arab-Israeli conflict. (4 marks)

4. Explain one consequence of US involvement in the Gulf War, 1991, for the PLO. (4 marks)

7. Explain one consequence of the 1993 Oslo Peace Accords. (4 marks)

10. Explain one consequence of the setting up of the Palestinian National Authority. (4 marks)

12. Explain one consequence of Oslo II, 1995. (4 marks)

5. Explain the importance of US involvement in the Gulf War, 1991, for the diplomatic strategy of the PLO. (8 marks)

6. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the peace process between Israel and the Palestinians, 1991-1995. (8 marks)

8. Explain the importance of the Oslo Accords for the conflict in the Middle East. (8 marks)

9. Explain the importance of Oslo II, 1995, for the Middle East peace process. (8 marks)

11. Write a narrative account analysing attempts at a solution in the years 1988–95. (8 marks)

Documentary / General Notes

Title / Topic: _____

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

Appendix: Further Watching

Scan the QR codes below to watch historical documentaries and videos related to each lesson.
Use these for independent revision or homework.

KT1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949



**Palestine Population &
Jewish Immigration**

7 mins 57 secs



**Britain's WW1 gamble |
Origins of the Israel-
Palestine Conflict | Part 1**

15 mins 44 secs



Historical Video

Duration not found



**Exodus 1947 Documentary
Trailer**

3 mins 10 secs



**Pre-IDF Brigades: Haganah,
Irgun and Lechi | History of
Israel Explained | Unpacked**

13 mins 54 secs



**Palestine Bomb Outrage
(1946)**

3 mins 16 secs



KING DAVID HOTEL BLOWN UP

2 mins 29 secs



Resolution 181: The Zionist Dream Comes True | History of Israel Explained | Unpacked

8 mins 40 secs



Historical Video

Duration not found



29 November 1947 - UN Passes Resolution 181 - The Partition Plan

2 mins 21 secs



The Balfour Declaration's impact, 100 years on

8 mins 3 secs



Ben-Gurion - One Place, One People

22 mins 38 secs



A brief history of US support for Israel

7 mins 41 secs



Historical Video

Duration not found

KT1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War



**The Arab-Israeli War of
1948 and Nakba explained**

5 mins 29 secs



**1948 Israeli War of
Independence | History of
Israel Explained | Unpacked**

10 mins 42 secs



**IsraelPalestine For Critical
Thinkers: #9 Independence
or Nakba**

6 mins 0 secs



**How did the Nakba happen?
| Al Jazeera English**

6 mins 13 secs



**The Brink of War: Suez
Crisis: (1/2)**
14 mins 4 secs



**A Global Flashpoint: Suez
Crisis (2/2)**
14 mins 56 secs



**Nasser: From Dream to
Disaster | History | Subtitled
Documentary**
53 mins 4 secs



**Nasser: From Dream to
Disaster | History | Subtitled
Documentary**
53 mins 4 secs



Historical Video
Duration not found



Historical Video
Duration not found

KT2.1: The Six Day War, 1967



Here's How the Six-Day War Changed the Map of the Middle East | History

4 mins 22 secs



Arab-Israeli War 1967 (Six-Day War Documentary)

22 mins 55 secs



S3e6 Battle For The Holy City The Six Day War Days That Shook The World

45 mins 0 secs



Six Days of Miracles

10 mins 9 secs



Arab-Israeli War 1967 (Six-Day War Documentary)

22 mins 55 secs



1967: A Story of Occupation

3 mins 22 secs



**Who Will Fire First?
(Survival of a Nation)**

7 mins 23 secs



**War on Three Fronts
(Survival of a Nation)**

9 mins 56 secs



**The W@r Israel Wasn't
Supposed to Survive |
Unpacked**

18 mins 16 secs

KT2.2: The Aftermath of the 1967 War



Resolution 242

9 mins 3 secs



Historical Video

Duration not found

KT2.3: Israel and Egypt, 1967–1973



Golda trailer

2 mins 8 secs



**Israel at War: 1973 | 5
Minute Videos | PragerU**

5 mins 52 secs



**Yom Kippur War Explained
1973: A Brief History**

3 mins 8 secs



**The Yom Kippur War:
Behind The Valley of Tears
(Part 1) | History of Israel
Explained | Unpacked**

10 mins 49 secs



**Yom Kippur War Explained
1973: A Brief History**

3 mins 8 secs



**The Yom Kippur War: How
Israel Turned the Tide (Part
2) | History of Israel
Explained | Unpacked**

9 mins 58 secs



   **Yom Kippur WAR of
1973 in GREAT HD!!**

36 mins 23 secs



**BBC World Service -
Witness History, The 1973
Oil Crisis**

BBC audio/video



**Golda Meir: "You always
called me an old lady, didn't
you." (she jokingly reproved
Anwar Sadat)**

1 mins 2 secs

KT3.1: Diplomatic negotiations, 1974–1979



**When Anwar Sadat visited
Israel | Turning Point**

1 mins 45 secs



**Here's How the Camp David
Accords Impacted the
Middle East | History**

4 mins 9 secs



**WE REMEMBER - Israel and
Egypt Peace treaty**

1 mins 29 secs



**The Egypt-Israel peace
treaty**

1 mins 41 secs



**Anwar Sadat Visits Israel
(This Week in Jewish
History) Dr. Henry
Abramson**

6 mins 4 secs



**The Munich Massacre |
History of Israel Explained |
Unpacked**

11 mins 8 secs



**S1e8 Black September
Hijackings Days That Shook
The World**

45 mins 0 secs



**Black September: When
Palestine Almost Stole
Jordan | Full Documentary**

13 mins 51 secs



**SEPTEMBER 5 | Official
Trailer (2024 Movie)**

2 mins 23 secs



**The Munich Massacre |
History of Israel Explained |
Unpacked**

11 mins 8 secs



**Black September: When
Palestine Almost Stole
Jordan | Full Documentary**

13 mins 51 secs



**Micro History: The First
Lebanon War (1982)**

2 mins 37 secs



**What Were The Palestinian
Intifadas? | NowThis World**

5 mins 12 secs



**Micro History: First Intifada
(1987-1993)**

1 mins 59 secs



**NAILA AND THE UPRISING :
The First Intifada Begins**

2 mins 24 secs



**Palestine Remix - How the
Gulf War Weakened the PLO**

1 mins 48 secs



**The Gulf War in Israel,
Explained**

4 mins 30 secs



**Yasser Arafat Speech
Young at the United Nations
in 1974 [English subtitles]**

10 mins 3 secs



Historical Video

Duration not found



Historical Video

Duration not found



Israeli settlements, explained | Settlements Part 1

8 mins 5 secs



Palestinian ambassador Husam Zomlot wants 'clear commitment from UK to fix the mess created here'

10 mins 24 secs

KT3.3: Attempts at a solution, 1988–1995



The Price of Oslo (Episode 1) | Al Jazeera World Documentary

47 mins 15 secs



The Price of Oslo (Episode 2) | Al Jazeera World Documentary

47 mins 30 secs



The Oslo Accords | History Lessons

6 mins 37 secs



Have Israelis & Palestinians Ever Made Peace? | The Oslo Accords Explained

13 mins 10 secs



How and why Oslo Accords failed

4 mins 42 secs



How Israel automated occupation in Hebron | The Listening Post

25 mins 20 secs



Why Did Israel Refrain from Retaliating against Iraq in 1991?

2 mins 19 secs



Historical Video

Duration not found

